NDSU AGRICULTURAL RISK POLICY CENTER

The Anatomy of Crop Insurance Policies and What U.S. Producers Chose, 2025

ARPC REPORT 2026–06

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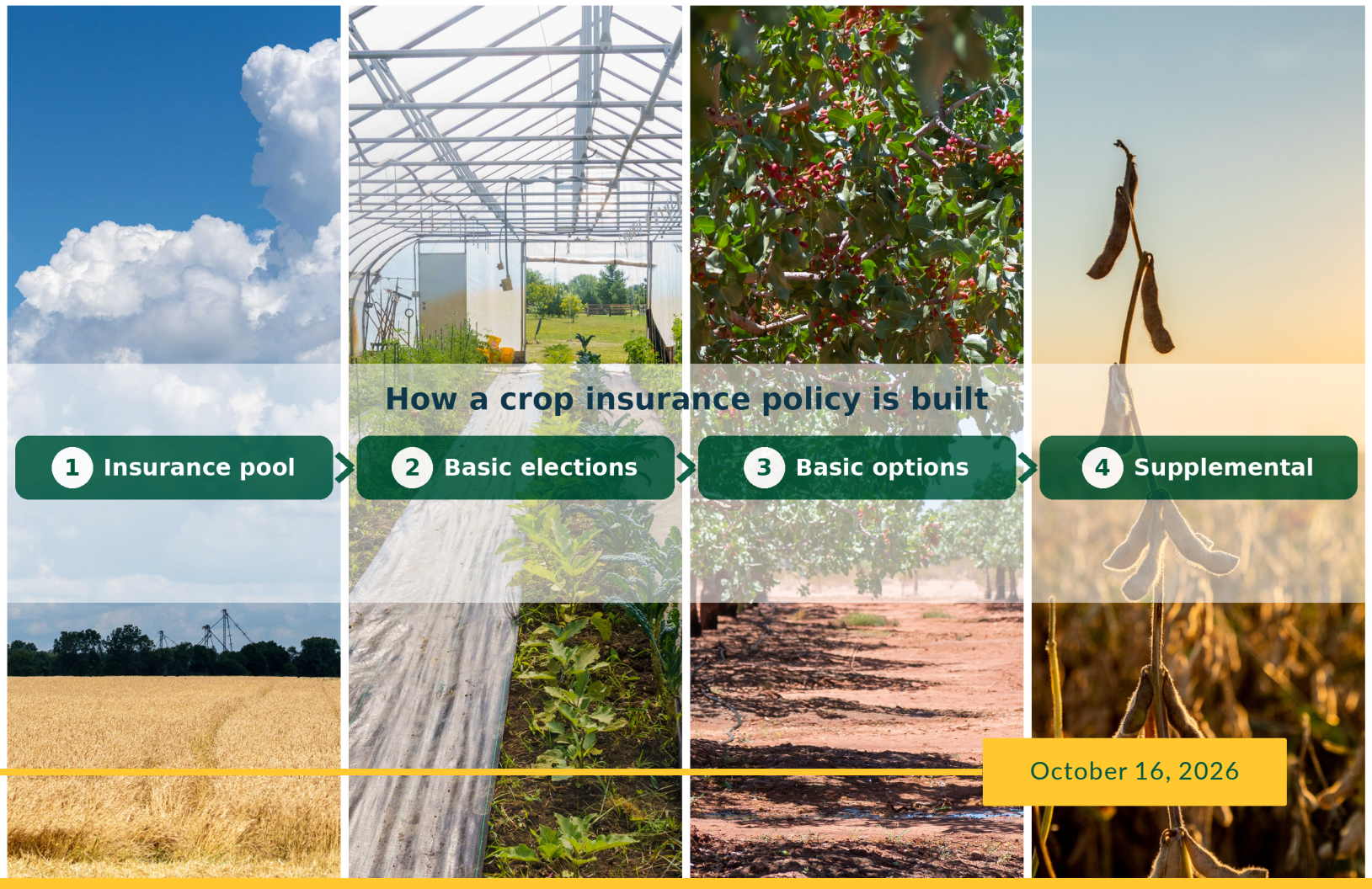

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Summary

This ARPC Report documents how U.S. producers configured Federal Crop Insurance Program (FCIP) policies between 2006 and 2025, from the production context through supplemental coverage. Drawing on USDA Risk Management Agency program-level and producer-level FCIP records, it maps insured acres and liabilities across policy layers, commodity groups, and regions. Key trends stand out: most liability sits in individual revenue plans, while area- and index-based plans cover more acres at lower value per acre; coverage has shifted into higher bands; and Enterprise Units, with much lower producer-paid premiums, are now the main choice for individual plans. Yield-history options dominate the options layer, and supplemental coverage, though still small, expanded sharply in 2025 after subsidy increases. Written agreements cover a small and declining share of acres, a sign that diverse production is steadily moving inside the program's standard offer. The report closes by tracing how confirmed 2026 and 2027 policy changes, led by the One Big Beautiful Bill Act subsidy increases and the phase-out of prevented-planting buy-up coverage, may reshape these choices.

Keywords: Federal Crop Insurance Program, insurance plans, coverage levels, unit structures, supplemental endorsements, producer participation

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Key Insights

- **Enterprise Units carry most insured acres and liability, and they cost producers less.** Premium data show why: Enterprise Units carry higher subsidy rates and much lower producer-paid premiums per acre than Optional or Basic Units.
- **Revenue plans account for most insured dollars, while area and index plans cover more acres.** Individual revenue products hold the largest liability share, led by corn, soybeans, wheat, and cotton. The Pasture, Rangeland, and Forage Rainfall Index covers many acres at low value per acre, so its liability share trails its acreage.
- **Coverage has shifted upward, with acres and liability concentrated at 70 percent and above.** Catastrophic and the lowest buy-up bands have receded. Because the highest band includes many area- and index-based plans, chiefly the Rainfall Index, bands are best read within each plan family, not as one overall measure.
- **A few options make up most of the basic policy choices.** Of eight categories, yield-history adjustments (Yield Adjustment, Yield Cup, Trend Adjustment, and Yield Exclusion) cover the most acres, mainly in major row crops. The largest outside that group, the prevented-planting buy-up, is being phased out under the Expanding Access to Risk Protection rule in 2026 and 2027, though USDA committed in July 2026 to restore it. Because options combine, these shares show the mix chosen, not participation.
- **Liability is based on the producer's share of interest, not just the number of acres.** It reflects the producer's ownership in the crop, not the landlord's; producers hold about 95 percent program-wide, lowest in Corn Belt and Plains row crops and close to 100 percent for most fruit, nut, forage, and vegetable crops.
- **The shrinking use of written agreements signals the program's widening reach.** These negotiated policies, used where the standard documents do not fit, cover a small and falling share of insured acres. The decline reflects not a retreat from these crops but their steady move into the standard program.
- **Supplemental coverage is a small but rapidly growing part of the program.** It covers a small share of insured acres, mostly in row-crop regions; enrollment jumped in 2025 after subsidy increases, and hurricane-wind coverage concentrates in coastal fruit and nut states.

Introduction

The Federal Crop Insurance Program (FCIP) is a central component of the U.S. agricultural risk management system, providing subsidized protection against yield and revenue losses arising from weather shocks, price volatility, and other production risks (Harwood et al., 1999; Turner et al., 2023; Tsiboe et al., 2025d; Baldwin et al., 2026). The program's active offer menu has grown from eight insurance plans in 1989 to more than thirty basic and endorsement plans today, and over that period insured liability has come to span nearly every major U.S. crop. Companion ARPC backgrounders have characterized the size and growth of this portfolio and the share of cropland enrolled in it (Tsiboe et al., 2026b; Tsiboe et al., 2026c). The corresponding question of how producers configure a policy once they decide to insure has remained largely undocumented.

An FCIP policy is not a single product but a structured set of producer elections. After defining the insured production context, commodity, location, class or subclass, practice, and use, the producer chooses a unit structure, basic insurance plan, coverage level, price election, share of interest in production, and any applicable options or endorsements. These choices jointly determine how losses are recognized, what type of risk is insured, how much of the expected outcome is guaranteed, and how the guarantee is valued. As a result, two policies with the same insured acres or liability can represent very different financial exposures. For example, a 75 percent revenue policy on an Enterprise Unit (EU) is not equivalent to a 75 percent yield policy on an Optional Unit (OU). Program participation totals are therefore most informative when interpreted alongside the joint distribution of producer choices. The complexity of these interacting elections has also motivated the development of producer-facing decision-support tools that simulate outcomes across alternative policy configurations (Gaku and Tsiboe, 2025; Tsiboe et al., 2025d; Serrano et al., 2026).

The producer choice menu has also changed substantially over time. Revenue insurance was introduced in 1996 through Crop Revenue Coverage, Income Protection, and Revenue Assurance. The 2011 Common Crop Insurance Policy Basic Provisions consolidation, commonly known as the COMBO consolidation, later merged those products and Actual Production History (APH) coverage into three core plans: Yield Protection (YP), Revenue Protection (RP), and Revenue Protection with Harvest Price Exclusion (RP-HPE) (Tsiboe et al., 2025d; Tsiboe and Turner, 2025; Gaku and Tsiboe, 2025). Subsequent reforms further altered producer incentives and available coverage options, including the 2008 Farm Bill's increased premium subsidies for EU, the 2014 Farm Bill's authorization of supplemental insurance, the

2018 Farm Bill's higher administrative fee for Catastrophic coverage (CAT), and recent One Big Beautiful Bill Act (OBBB) changes raising premium subsidies on both the unit-structure and supplemental margins beginning in the 2026 crop year (Turner and Arita, 2025; Tsiboe and Zhao, 2026). Because these reforms changed both what producers could select and what they were encouraged to select, observed shifts in coverage may reflect producer preferences, product availability, subsidy incentives, or all three.

This report addresses that gap. Using 2006–2025 FCIP data, it documents the distribution of insured acres and liabilities across the five core elections (unit structure, basic insurance plan, coverage level, basic policy options and endorsements, and supplemental coverage) and how each distribution varies across major commodity groups and U.S. regions. The analysis is descriptive and institutional in scope: it does not estimate causal effects, evaluate welfare outcomes, or advance policy recommendations. Within this framework, the report addresses five core questions:

- How are insured acres and liabilities distributed across the major basic insurance plan groups, and how has that distribution evolved across the analytic window?
- How are insured acres distributed across unit structures, and what role have the post-2008 subsidy changes played in reshaping that distribution?
- How are insured acres and liabilities distributed across coverage-level bands, and how has the share of acres at the upper bands changed relative to Catastrophic and the lower buy-up bands?
- How are insured acres distributed across the basic policy options layer, and which functional categories of options carry the largest acreage in the current crop year?
- How do basic policy choices vary across major commodity groups and U.S. regions, and where does the program-wide trend conceal substantial heterogeneity?

The descriptive evidence indicates a program whose internal composition is structurally different from what any single acreage or liability total would suggest. The plan composition has migrated decisively toward individual revenue products, with RP alone bearing the largest share of program liability and area- and index-based plans driving most of the recent acreage expansion. The unit-structure composition has shifted from Basic Units (BU) and OU toward EU, with the migration dating to the higher EU subsidies authorized by the 2008 Farm Bill; EU now carries a markedly lower producer-paid premium per acre than other unit structures. The coverage-level distribution has shifted upward, with the share of insured acres at the 80-85 and 90-95 percent bands expanding as the lower buy-up bands and CAT have receded, though the highest-band acreage partly reflects area- and index-based plans and should be read within

plan families. The basic policy options layer is dominated by yield-history modifiers, with Yield Adjustment accounting for the largest single share of insured option-acres. The supplemental layer has expanded most among field crops, with the Supplemental Coverage Option (SCO) and the Enhanced Coverage Option (ECO) accelerating after their respective subsidy enhancements. These elections are all made from an offer menu that is itself expanding unevenly across commodities and states, and the small, declining share of acres insured through written agreements indicates that production once insurable only by individual negotiation is increasingly covered by the standard offer. Underlying all of these comparisons, the program insures the producer's share of interest, the producer's own economic stake in the crop as distinct from the landlord's, rather than acres in the abstract; that share approaches 95 percent program-wide and is lowest in the row-crop core, so regional liability comparisons reflect contractual stake as well as acres, yields, and prices.

Each of these national trends conceals pronounced commodity-by-region heterogeneity: Iowa field-crop producers cluster at higher coverage bands than the national average, nut acreage continues to favor BU, forage coverage sits below the field-crop norm in the Midwest and West, with Kansas the exception, and the West and the row-crop core differ systematically in their unit-structure profile. These patterns provide a foundation for interpreting future shifts in producer policy choices, particularly as the OBBB and the Expanding Access to Risk Protection (EARP) final rule reshape unit structure, coverage, supplemental layers, and the prevented-planting buy-up option beginning with the 2026 and 2027 crop years; the buy-up removal is itself now subject to a July 2026 USDA commitment to restore the option, pending formal RMA guidance (Chakravorty et al., 2026).

The remainder of the report proceeds in two movements. The first establishes how a crop insurance policy is built: Section 2 describes the data and methods, and Section 3 lays out the structural anatomy of an FCIP policy, the staged sequence of elections, and the production context in which they are made. The second documents what U.S. producers chose over 2006–2025, taking the five core elections in the order a policy is assembled: unit structure (Section 4), basic insurance plan (Section 5), coverage level (Section 6), basic policy options and endorsements (Section 7), and supplemental coverage (Section 8). Section 9 closes with an outlook that traces how the confirmed 2025–2027 policy changes may reshape these choices beginning in the 2026 and 2027 crop years.

Data and Methods

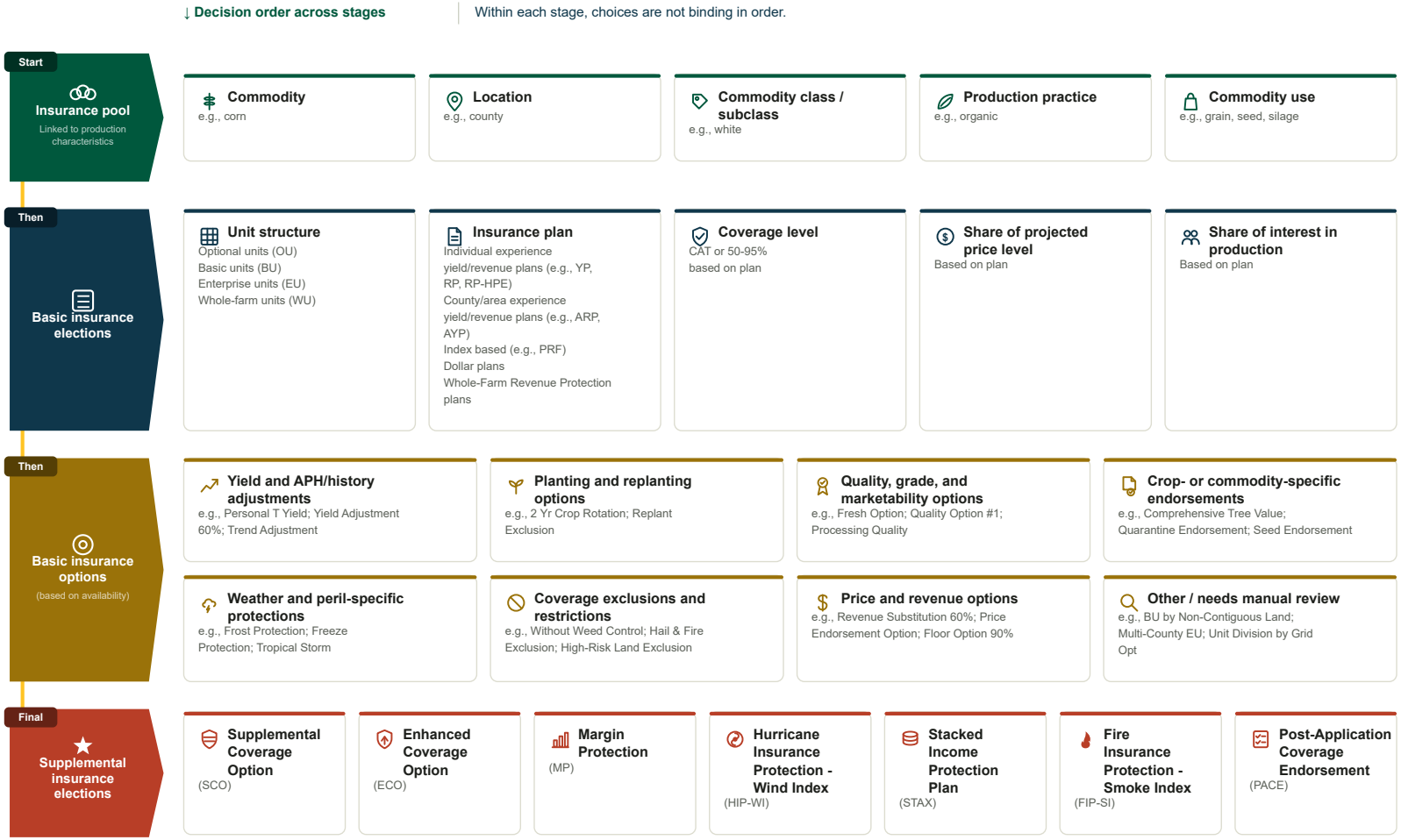
This report draws on RMA administrative crop insurance records, chiefly the Summary of Business (SOB), supplemented by the RMA Insurance Choice Election (ICE) catalog and producer-level policy data from the FCIP Policy Acceptance and Storage System (PASS). The analysis aggregates commodities into five broader groups (Field Crops, Vegetables, Nuts, Fruits, and Forages). It characterizes producer policy choice through two complementary indicators: insured liability (the dollar value of production risk transferred, in billions of nominal U.S. dollars) and net reported acres (the breadth of insured participation, in millions of acres). The national figures span crop years 2006 through 2025; the Summary of Business data vintage is October 15, 2026, and the producer-level data vintage is May 5, 2026.

The approach is descriptive and institutional. It maps how insured acres and liabilities distribute across each producer election and how those distributions vary by commodity group and region; it does not estimate causal effects, evaluate welfare outcomes, or advance policy recommendations. Because the SOB records what producers purchased rather than the full menu available to them, observed shares mix producer preference with what the program actually offered in each crop-county setting. Full detail on the data sources and vintage, the unit of analysis, key variable definitions, the filtering and transformation steps, the period windows used for each exhibit, and the study's limitations is provided in the Data and Methodology appendix (Appendix A).

Structure of an FCIP Policy

Under the FCIP, producers do not simply decide whether to insure a crop. They select a set of interrelated policy features that together define the scope, value, and form of protection. At a minimum, this involves electing a unit structure (for many products), an insurance plan, and a coverage level. These choices are made within the insured crop's production context and may be further refined through optional or supplemental endorsements. The result is a structured but flexible policy design process that allows producers to tailor coverage to their production setting and risk management needs. Figure 1 summarizes this staged process, while Box 2 through Box 8 provide additional detail on key policy-design components. Read from top to bottom, the figure is also the report's roadmap: the stages appear in the order a policy is assembled, and the body sections that follow take them up in that same order.

Figure 1: *Structure of a U.S. Federal Crop Insurance Program Policy.*



Note: The figure summarizes the staged sequence of producer elections under the Federal Crop Insurance Program. Stage 1 is the insured production context (commodity, location, commodity class or subclass, production practice, and commodity use), which determines the menu of policies for which a producer is eligible. Stage 2 is the unit structure (Optional, Basic, Enterprise, or Whole-Farm Units; see Box 2). Stage 3 is the choice of basic insurance plan (yield, revenue, area or index, whole-farm, or dollar; see Boxes 3 and 4). Stage 4 is the coverage level and price-and-share election (see Box 5). Stage 5 is the layer of options and supplemental endorsements that modify or extend the underlying contract (see Boxes 6 through 8). Each stage is discussed in turn in the body of the report.

Source: NDSU Agricultural Risk Policy Center (ARPC) using data from USDA Risk Management Agency Crop Policy documents, as of October 15, 2026.

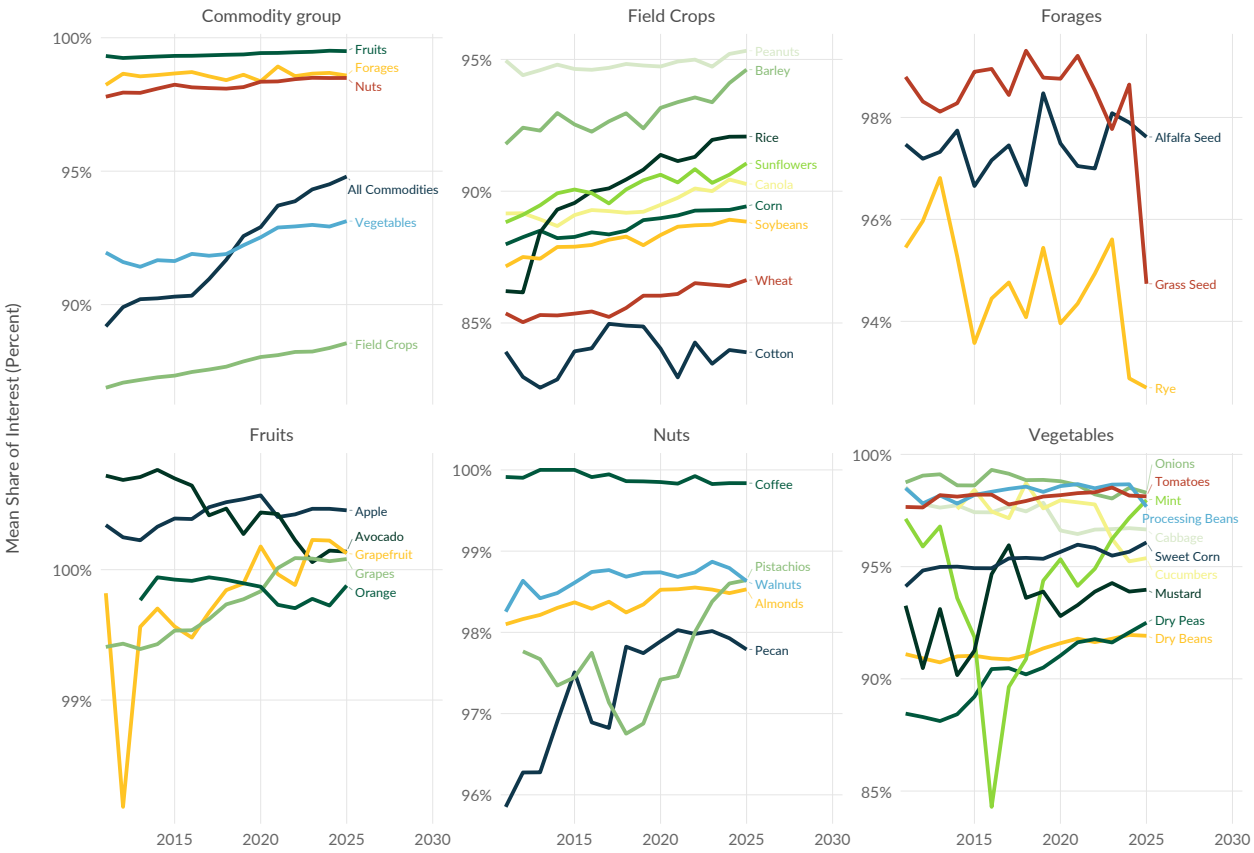
The process begins with the insured production context, or insurance pool: the set of production characteristics that define the policy environment in which a producer operates. As shown in Figure 1, these characteristics include the commodity, location, commodity class or subclass, production practice, and commodity use.

These are not merely descriptive details. They determine policy availability, rating, and contract design. A producer growing the same crop in a different county, under irrigated rather than non-irrigated practice, or for a different commodity use may face different policy terms, premium rates, and available endorsements. In this sense, the FCIP first defines the nature of the insured risk before the producer selects among policy alternatives. This framing is important because the menu of options available for a given crop-county-practice setting always conditions observed producer choices.

The producer's share of interest, that is, the producer's own ownership stake in the crop as opposed to a landlord's, is central to FCIP policy design because the program insures the producer's economic stake in the crop, not acreage alone. In practical terms, a producer on a 50-50 crop-share lease insures their half of the harvest, not the whole field. Producers generally must insure all acres of a crop in which they hold a share within the insured unit, whether through crop-share or cash-rent arrangements. Because liability is scaled to the insured share, the policy protects only the portion of production for which the producer bears financial gain or loss. As a result, two producers farming the same acreage under similar policies may have different liabilities and premium obligations if their ownership shares differ.

Producers hold nearly all of the economic stake the program insures, and that stake has been growing. Figure 2 reports the acre-weighted mean share of interest (each policy weighted by its insured acres, so larger operations count proportionally more than smaller ones) from 2011 through 2025, both program-wide and for the leading commodities within each commodity group. Program-wide, the mean share rose steadily from roughly 89 percent in 2011 to 95 percent in 2025, an increase of about 6 percentage points over the analytic window. This gradual rise is consistent with the long-run shift in farmland rental markets away from crop-share leases and toward cash-rent arrangements, under which the operator retains a full interest in production. Across commodity groups in 2025, mean shares range from 89 percent for Field Crops to 99 percent for Fruits. The commodity-level panels show that the gap is concentrated in the major row crops, including Cotton (at about 84 percent, the lowest among leading commodities). At the same time, most fruit, nut, forage, and vegetable production is insured at or near full interest. Current-year records are incomplete at this vintage, so the sharp end-of-series swings in some thinly traded Forages and Vegetables specialties are preliminary rather than real tenure shifts.

Figure 2: ***Producer's Share of Interest in Production, by Commodity.***

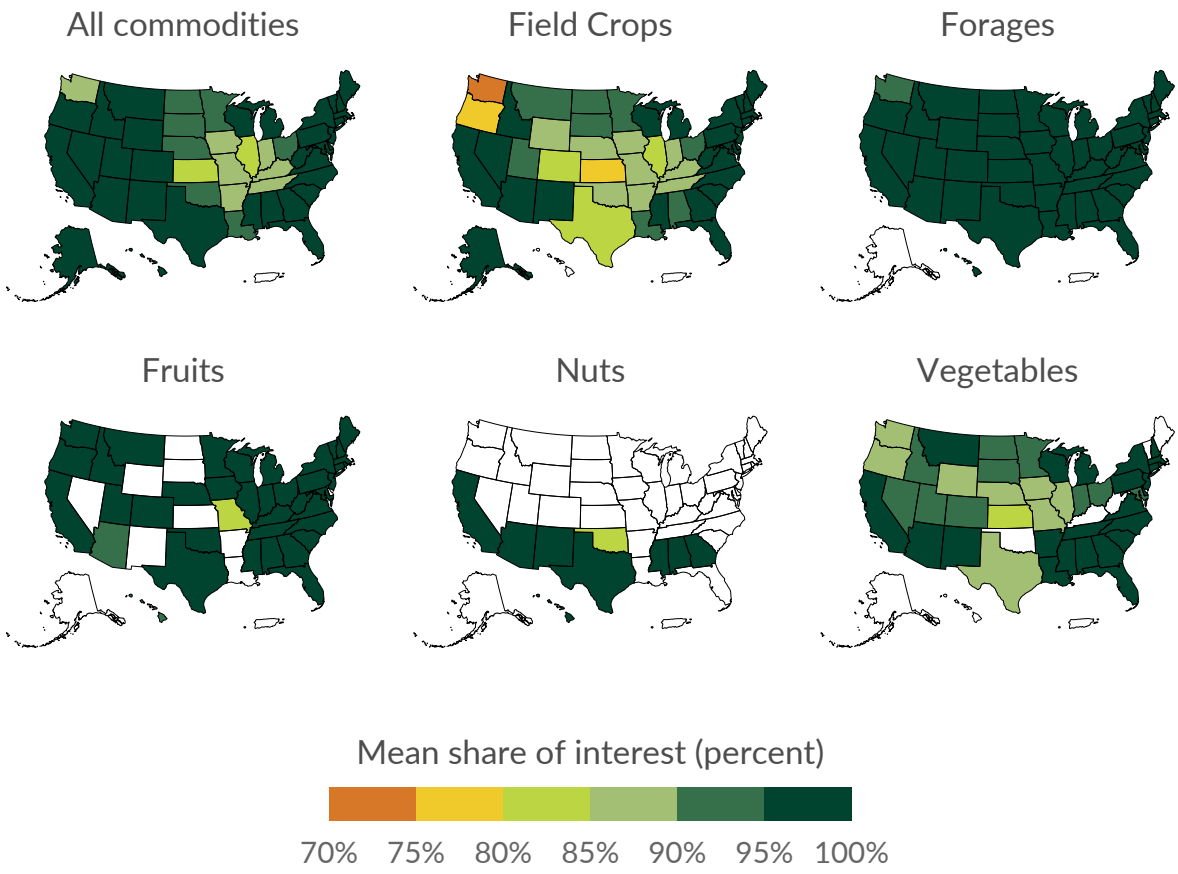


Note: Time-series of the producer's mean share of interest in production (weighted by insured acres) from 2011 through 2025. A share of 100 percent indicates that the insured producer holds full economic interest in the crop on the insured unit.

Source: NDSU Agricultural Risk Policy Center (ARPC) using producer-level data from the USDA Risk Management Agency FCIP Policy Acceptance and Storage System, as of May 5, 2026.

The geography of shares of interest reinforces the tenure interpretation. Figure 3 maps state-level means in 2025, program-wide and by commodity group. Mean shares are lowest, near 83 percent in Illinois, across the Corn Belt and central Plains, where crop-share leasing of rented cropland is most common, and rise toward 100 percent in the Northeast and in states whose insured portfolios are dominated by fruit, nut, and other specialty production. This spatial pattern matters for interpretation throughout the report: regional comparisons of insured liability reflect not only differences in acres, yields, and prices, but also systematic differences in the contractual stake producers hold in those acres. In the commodity-group panels, unshaded states carry no insured acreage in that group, which is why the Nuts map is largely blank.

Figure 3: ***Producer's Share of Interest in Production, by State and Commodity Group.***



Note: State-level means of the producer's share of interest in production (weighted by insured acres) in 2025. A share of 100 percent indicates that insured producers hold full economic interest in the crop on the insured unit.

Source: NDSU Agricultural Risk Policy Center (ARPC) using producer-level data from the USDA Risk Management Agency FCIP Policy Acceptance and Storage System, as of May 5, 2026.

FCIP policies are priced on an actuarially sound basis, with premium rates varying by plan, coverage level, commodity, commodity type, production practice, location, and other contract features (Tsiboe and Turner, 2023; Turner et al., 2023; Tsiboe et al., 2025b). The Federal Crop Insurance Corporation (FCIC) then subsidizes a portion of producer premiums, with subsidy rates differing by plan type, coverage level, and, in some cases, unit structure (see Table 1). Two patterns in the schedule do much of the interpretive work in the sections that follow. First, subsidy rates fall as coverage rises: on the core individual yield and revenue plans, the BU and OU rate slides from 67 percent at the 50 percent coverage level to 41 percent at 85 percent, so a producer buying up coverage takes on an accelerating share of the premium out of pocket.

Table 1: ***Crop Insurance Premium Subsidies Schedule For 2026.***

	Coverage level in percentage										
	CAT	50	55	60	65	70	75	80	85	90	95
On farm experience-based basic plans											
Actual Revenue History (ARH); Yield Protection (YP); Revenue Protection (RP); Revenue Protection with Harvest Price Exclusion (RP-HPE); Pecan Revenue (PRV); Production Revenue History (PRH)	100	67 (80)	69 (80)	69 (80)	64 (80)	64 (80)	60 (80)	51 (71)	41 (56)	-	-
Crop and Livestock Income Protection (CLIP)	-	-	80	80	80	80	80	71	56	-	-
Whole Farm Revenue Protection (WFRP)	-	80	80	80	80	80	80	71	56	56	-
Group-based basic plans											
Area Revenue Protection (ARP); Area Revenue Protection - Harvest Price Exclusion (ARP - HPE)	-	-	-	-	-	59	55	55	49	44	-
Area Yield Protection (AYP)	100	-	-	-	-	59	59	55	55	51	-
Dollar Plans	100	67	69	69	64	64	60	51	41	-	-
Margin Protection (MP)	-	-	-	-	-	59	55	55	49	44	44
Stacked Income Protection Plan (STAX)	-	-	-	-	-	-	80	80	80	80	-
Supplemental plans											
Enhanced Coverage Option (ECO)	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	80	80
Fire Insurance Protection - Smoke Index (FIP-SI)	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	80
Hurricane Insurance Protection - Wind Index (HIP-WI)	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	80
Margin Coverage Option (MCO)	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	80	80
Post-Application Coverage Endorsement (PACE)	-	-	-	-	-	-	60	51	41	41	-
Supplemental Coverage Option (SCO)	-	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	-	-

Note: Each cell reports two subsidy rates: the Basic/Optional Unit rate shown first, followed by the Enterprise Unit rate in parentheses. For example, 67 (80) denotes a 67 percent subsidy on Basic or Optional Units and an 80 percent subsidy on Enterprise Units. A single value indicates that the two rates are identical or that only one unit structure is offered. A dash indicates that the coverage level or unit structure is not offered for the corresponding plan. CAT denotes catastrophic coverage. Basic Units cover land in one county with the same tenants and landlords; Optional Units divide a Basic Unit by township section; and Enterprise Units cover all land of one crop in a county for a producer. Individual yield and revenue plans are based on the producer's farm-level production experience. Rates are drawn from RMA premium subsidy schedule records for the 2026 program year.

Source: NDSU Agricultural Risk Policy Center (ARPC) using data from USDA Risk Management Agency published premium subsidy schedules for the 2026 program year, as of October 15, 2026.

Second, at every buy-up level the parenthetical EU rate sits well above the BU and OU rate (56 versus 41 percent at the 85 percent level); this is the subsidy wedge behind the unit-structure migration documented in Section 4, just as the coverage-level gradient shapes the distributions documented in Section 6. Table 1 reports the published schedule for the 2026 program year, which already incorporates the OBBB subsidy increases discussed in Section 9; the rates in force over the 2006–2025 analytic window differed at some coverage levels. Observed producer choices therefore reflect risk preferences and farm characteristics as well as the premium and subsidy incentives embedded in FCIP design.

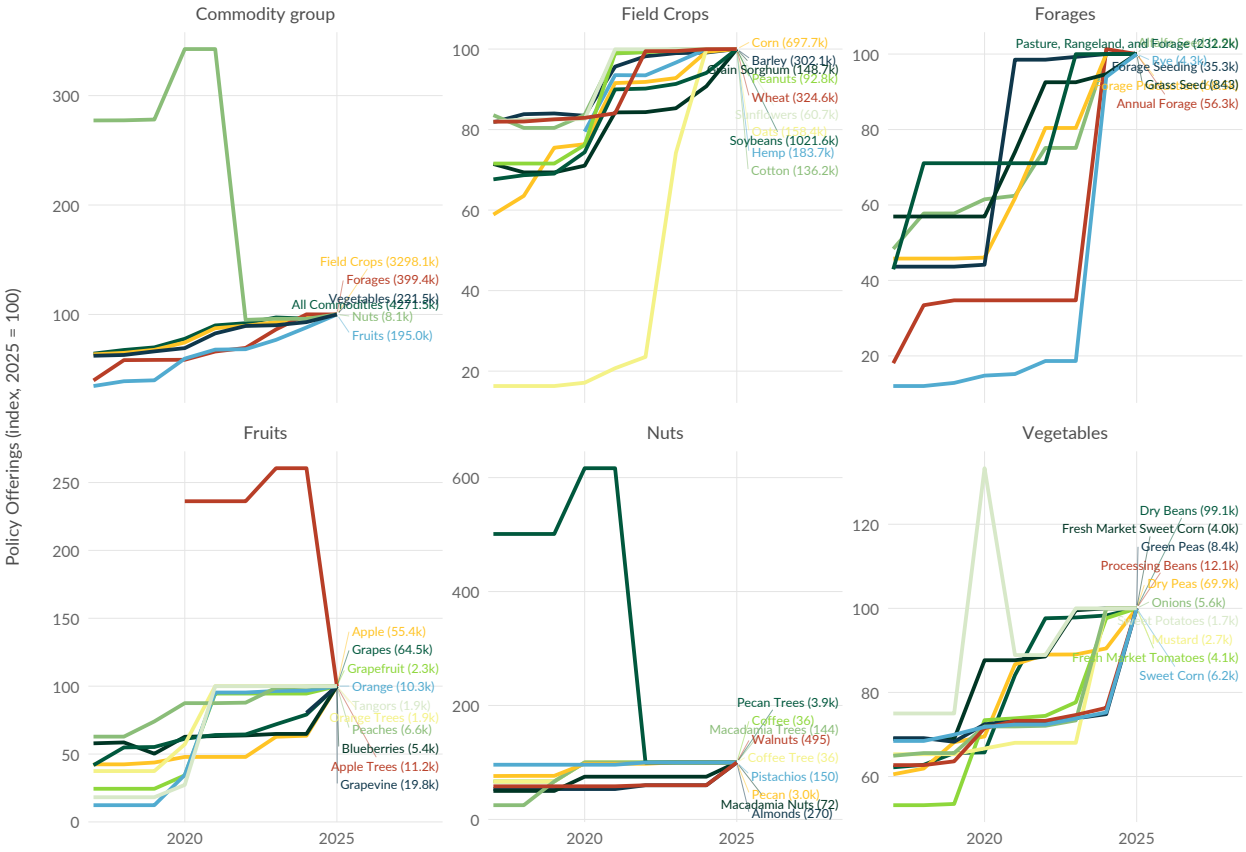
The Scope of FCIP Policy Offerings

The menu a producer faces is large and strikingly uneven before a single election is made. In 2025 the program recorded about 4.3 million distinct offerings across all commodities, yet that abundance is not shared: breadth runs from dozens of options for a major crop in a Corn Belt county to a bare handful, or none at all, for a specialty crop near the edge of its growing range. Each offering is one unit-structure choice available within a distinct crop-county-type-practice setting, fixed in RMA's actuarial documents; a corn policy in a county that permits optional, basic, and enterprise units, for example, contributes three offerings, so the count measures the depth of the menu rather than simply the number of crops or counties covered. Unlike the participation measures elsewhere in this report, the next two exhibits describe this *supply* side, what is offered rather than what was chosen.

The menu has also grown, and lopsidedly. Figure 4 traces distinct offerings by commodity from 2017 to 2025: program-wide the count rose about 56 percent, but its composition barely shifted. Field Crops still account for the large majority of all offerings, about 77 percent, essentially unchanged from 76 percent at the start of the window, so the expansion sits atop a menu that field crops already dominated. The steep proportional gains came in the specialty and forage groups growing from small bases: Fruits widened most, up roughly 189 percent, yet still make up only about 4.6 percent of offerings, up from 2.5 percent. Nuts moved the other way, the only group whose menu contracted, from about 22.5 thousand to 8.1 thousand offerings (down about 64 percent), a drop sharp enough that it likely reflects a reclassification in RMA's actuarial layout rather than a genuine withdrawal of products. The shape of the series points the same way: the Nut menu spikes to several times its baseline before collapsing within a few years, a trajectory more consistent with offerings being recounted under a revised actuarial grouping than with products entering and leaving the market at that scale. The current-year gross count beside each label indicates how different these menus remain in absolute size. In 2025 those gross counts, from the largest

group to the smallest, were: Field Crops (3.3 million), Forages (399.4 thousand), Vegetables (221.5 thousand), Fruits (195.0 thousand), Nuts (8.1 thousand).

Figure 4: ***Scope of the Number of FCIP Policy Offerings, by Commodity.***



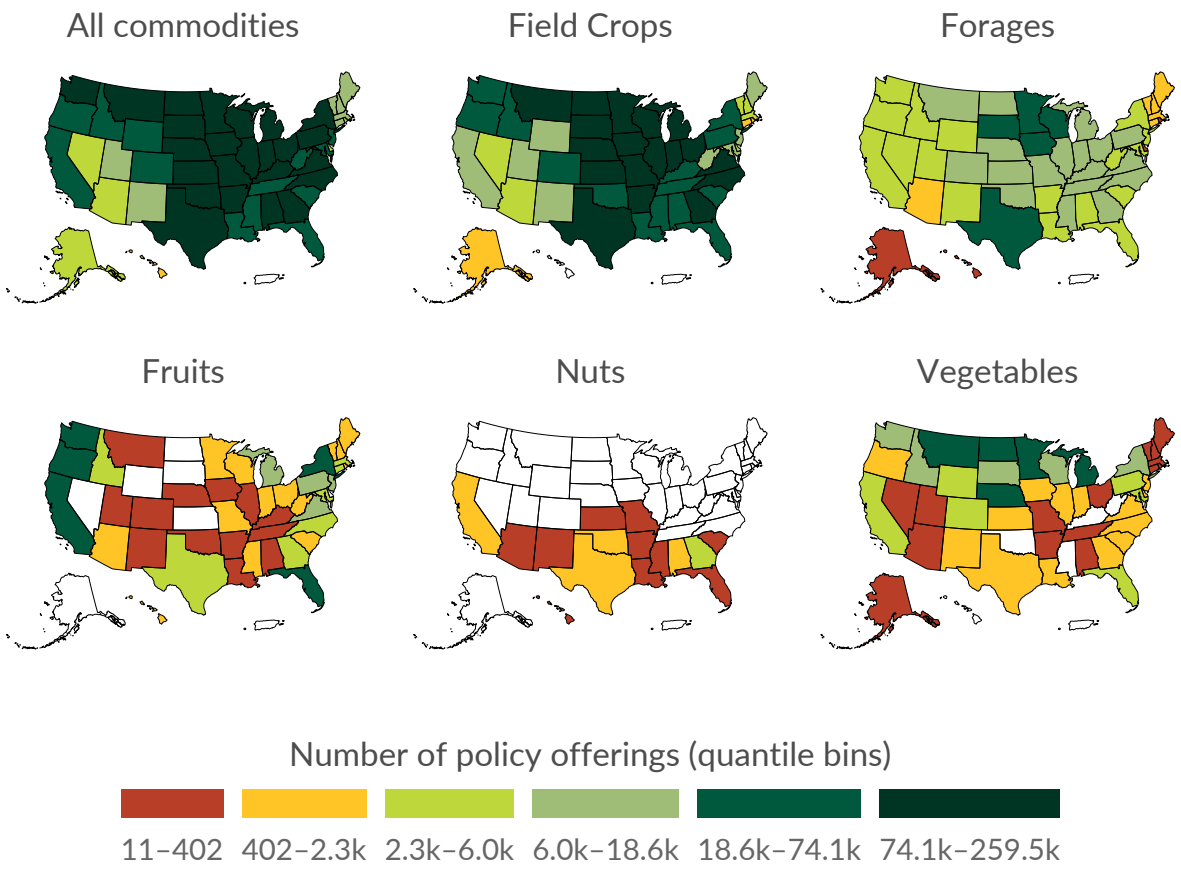
Note: Number of distinct FCIP policy offerings by commodity, indexed to 2025 = 100, 2017 through 2025; the value in parentheses on each label is the 2025 gross offering count. An offering is a unit-structure choice (optional, basic, enterprise, or whole-farm unit) available within a crop-county-type-practice actuarial offer; counts sum the allowed unit structures across all offers within each grouping.

Source: NDSU Agricultural Risk Policy Center (ARPC) using the USDA Risk Management Agency Actuarial Data Master (Insurance Offer, A00030), as of October 15, 2026.

Breadth is just as uneven across the map. Figure 5 maps offerings by state: they cluster where cropping is diverse and thin out where insured production is narrow, from Missouri at the top (about 259.5 thousand distinct offerings) to Hawaii at the bottom, a spread of roughly 197-fold. The count is highly concentrated: the ten states with the widest menus, large and crop-diverse states across the Midwest and Plains, together hold about 47 percent of all offerings, and the top five about 27 percent. Because the tally rises mechanically with the number of crops and counties a state spans, this geography tracks agricultural scale and diversity as much as the depth of choice facing any one producer. How the menu is

set explains part of that spread: RMA widens it through its own product development and through privately submitted products under Section 508(h) of the Federal Crop Insurance Act, many beginning as pilots. Because the offer in a given crop-county-practice setting fixes what a producer can even consider, everything in the rest of the report sits downstream of it: an option absent from a producer's setting cannot be chosen there, so the breadth of the offer both enables and bounds the choices analyzed in Sections 4 through 8.

Figure 5: ***Scope of the Number of FCIP Policy Offerings, by State and Commodity Group.***



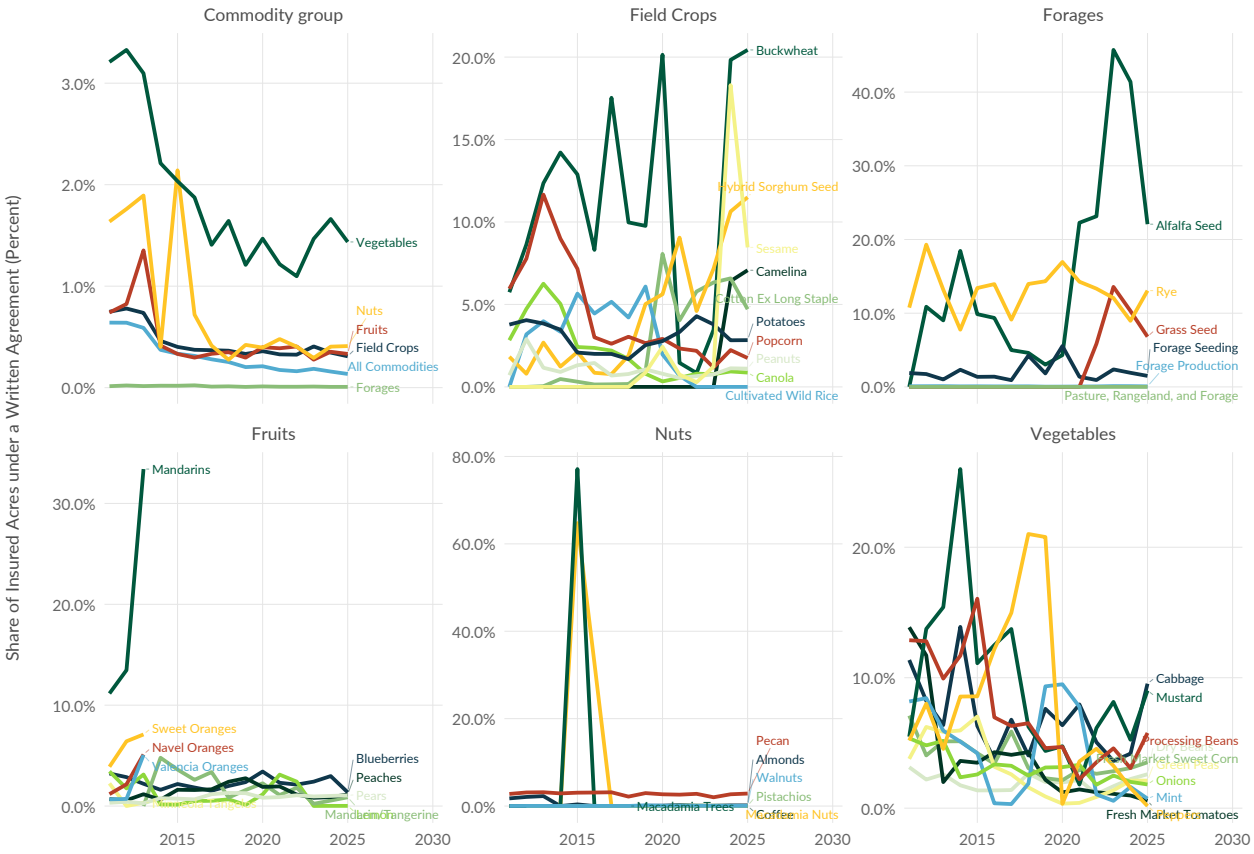
Note: State-level count of distinct FCIP policy offerings in 2025, program-wide and by commodity group, shaded in equal-count (quantile) bins. An offering is a unit-structure choice available within a crop-county-type-practice actuarial offer.

Source: NDSU Agricultural Risk Policy Center (ARPC) using the USDA Risk Management Agency Actuarial Data Master (Insurance Offer, A00030), as of October 15, 2026.

Written Agreements

For most producers the published offer is the whole story; for a minority it is not, and that minority is shrinking. A written agreement tailors an individual policy to circumstances the published actuarial documents do not cover, negotiated among the insured, the Approved Insurance Provider (AIP), and RMA; because these policies already sit inside every distribution in this report, they add no separate layer of coverage. Such agreements are rare across the program as a whole, covering only about 0.13 percent of insured acres in 2025, down from about 0.64 percent in 2011, a decline of nearly 79 percent that is shared by every commodity group (Figure 6).

Figure 6: ***FCIP Written Agreements, Share of Insured Acres by Commodity.***



Note: Acre-weighted share of insured acres carried under a written agreement, by commodity, 2011 through 2025. A written agreement tailors an individual policy to circumstances not addressed by the published actuarial documents; the share is the percent of insured acres in each grouping written under such an agreement.

Source: NDSU Agricultural Risk Policy Center (ARPC) using producer-level data from the USDA Risk Management Agency FCIP Policy Acceptance and Storage System, as of May 5, 2026.

They stay most concentrated in the specialty groups. Still, even there the retreat is pronounced: the Vegetable share fell from about 3.2 percent to 1.4 percent and the Nut share from about 1.6 percent to 0.4 percent over the window, with Fruit at 0.3 percent today. The commodity panels still show occasional single-year spikes, individual crops such as buckwheat or mandarins briefly written largely by agreement, but each sits on a very small acreage base.

What sends a producer down this path is concrete. A grower breaking ground for canola or sunflowers where the crop has no approved actuarial documents cannot buy a standard policy at all; a written agreement, which typically requires the crop to be insurable in a nearby county, is the only way to insure the field. A producer with a limited water supply, too little for a fully irrigated guarantee but more than the non-irrigated one assumes, can establish a limited-irrigation yield tier only by agreement. And a producer double-cropping soybeans or grain sorghum behind winter wheat, where that following-crop practice is not offered locally, reaches coverage the same way. Agreements take two forms, blanket (issued county-wide) and type-or-practice (written for an individual farm), and run for a single crop year or, for some types, several.

Across state-by-group combinations the share is near zero almost everywhere: 181 of 239 cells sit below one percent, with a median of about 0.12 percent, while only 6 exceed 20 percent and each of those sits on very small insured acreage, reaching as high as 100 percent in a single state-crop cell. Most of these spikes are vegetables grown in row-crop states, such as Mississippi, Colorado, and Kansas, where vegetables have no local actuarial documents of their own, so a grower reaches coverage the same way one would for any crop outside its established range.

This steady erosion is itself a marker of the program's widening reach. As bespoke arrangements prove out, RMA folds them into the published actuarial documents. Hence, production that once required an individual agreement, new crops, new practices, and new regions, increasingly arrives with a standard offer instead. Written agreements are in fact how the program delivers many of those options in the first place: the Specialty Trait Soybean program reached Indiana and Illinois this way for the 2026 crop year, and in one case the tool became national policy, as the 2022 Double Cropping Initiative used written agreements to expand insurable double-crop production across the Plains and Midwest (Box 1). The same window in which written-agreement use fell is the one in which the offer menu widened fastest in exactly these specialty and forage groups (Figure 4 and Figure 5), the supply-side counterpart to the same process. Read together, the falling written-agreement share is less a retreat from these crops than evidence that much of the country's diverse agriculture is steadily being drawn inside the standard bounds of the FCIP.

The remainder of this report analyzes how insured acres and liabilities are distributed across five core policy elections: unit structure, basic insurance plan, coverage level, basic policy options and endorsements, and supplemental coverage. It also examines how these distributions vary across major commodity groups and U.S. regions.

Box 1: The Double Cropping Initiative

Written agreements are usually a producer-by-producer accommodation, but they can also serve as an instrument of national policy. In July 2022, with global grain and oilseed supplies disrupted by the war in Ukraine, USDA moved to encourage more domestic production by making it easier to insure a second crop grown in the same year. Double cropping, planting soybeans or grain sorghum after a harvested winter wheat crop, had long been insurable only where the actuarial documents recognized the following-crop practice; elsewhere the second crop could be insured only by written agreement, one field at a time.

Rather than wait for the standard offer to catch up, the Risk Management Agency used the written-agreement mechanism itself as the delivery vehicle. It streamlined, and in many counties waived, the production-record requirements for double-crop written agreements, in effect pre-clearing the exception across large areas where double cropping is agronomically feasible but not separately offered. The action reached roughly 681 additional counties for double-crop soybeans and 870 for grain sorghum, spanning Michigan, Ohio, the Dakotas, Nebraska, Kansas, Oklahoma, and the Texas Panhandle, beginning with the 2023 crop year and continuing through 2026.

The episode illustrates the dual role of the written agreement in the program's architecture. Day-to-day, it is a safety valve, extending coverage to the individual producer whose crop, practice, or ground the published menu does not fit. But because it can be widened administratively and quickly, it also gives the Risk Management Agency a fast lever to expand insurable production in response to a market or policy objective, here food-supply security, without first rebuilding the standard actuarial offer.

Producer's Choice of Unit Structure

One of the first major producer elections under the FCIP is unit structure, which determines how acreage is pooled for loss recognition and premium calculation. For individual farm-based plans, producers typically choose among OU, BU, and EU, as described in Box 2. These unit choices differ mainly in the geographic and administrative scope over which production is pooled.

OU allow more disaggregation, often by farm serial number or comparable production division, which means a loss on one tract may trigger indemnity without being offset by better outcomes elsewhere. BU consolidate acreage under a common ownership share arrangement, while EU pool acreage more broadly,

often across the entire farming operation for a crop within a county. Broader aggregation generally reduces premium costs but requires the producer to absorb more intra-farm variation before losses trigger payments.

Whole-Farm Units (WU), where available, extend this pooling logic across crops, and Multi-County Enterprise Units (MCEU) are available where eligibility requirements are met. Because of this pooling-for-premium tradeoff, unit structure is not merely an administrative classification. It is a central feature of FCIP's approach to balancing individualized loss recognition, premium affordability, and actuarial risk transfer.

Box 2: Insurance Unit Structures

When a producer selects a crop insurance plan and coverage level, they must also choose how acreage will be grouped for insurance purposes. These unit structures are designed to accommodate different farm organizations and risk-management preferences.

- **Optional Units (OU):** Optional Units allow a producer to insure each farm section separately. When a producer has multiple sections, typically identified by Farm Serial Number (FSN) or an equivalent unit, losses in one section do not have to be offset by outcomes in another. This structure can provide more targeted protection when production risk varies across locations.
- **Basic Units (BU):** Basic Units combine acreage across sections when they are operated under the same share arrangement. Because losses are aggregated across a broader base, producer-paid premiums are generally lower than under Optional Units.
- **Enterprise Units (EU):** Enterprise Units combine all sections of the insured crop in a county into a single unit. This broader pooling generally reduces producer-paid premiums relative to Optional or Basic Units, but it also means that losses in one area may be offset by better outcomes elsewhere. Enterprise Units may also vary by practice, such as irrigated versus non-irrigated acreage. In some cases, producers may also use **Multi-County Enterprise Units (MCEU)** when eligibility requirements are met.
- **Whole-Farm Units (WU):** Whole-Farm Units combine all insured crops in a county into a single policy unit. This is the broadest form of aggregation and is commonly associated with whole-farm style coverage.

This section summarizes the distribution of insured liability and net reported acres across unit structures from 2006 to 2025. The analysis is restricted to individual experience-based insurance plans (described in the next section), as they are the only plans that allow multiple unit structure options. In the presentation, the unit of analysis is the commodity-year-by-unit-type, with unit codes consolidated into the OU, BU, and EU buckets described in Box 2; WU and MCEU are folded into EU (their shares are too small to display separately), and Appendix A details the full recode.

Unit Structure Election Trends

The defining fact of the unit-structure election is migration: over the 2006-to-2025 window, insured acres moved steadily toward the broader pooling of the Enterprise Unit (Figure 7). The window brackets the 2008 Farm Bill subsidy changes that first made EU broadly attractive: EU overtook OU in insured acres in 2012. In 2006, OU accounted for roughly 40.8 percent of insured acres, BU for 59.1 percent, and EU for about 0.1 percent; by 2025, EU accounted for 59.9 percent of insured acres and 55.9 percent of insured liability, compared with 25.0 percent of acres and 27.2 percent of liability for OU and 15.1 percent of acres and 16.9 percent of liability for BU. In 2025, EU carried roughly 143.6 million insured acres and $72.6 billion in insured liability.

Figure 7: *U.S. Federal Crop Insurance Liability and Acreage by Unit Structure.*

Note: Each panel shows the within-year share of insured liability (top row) and net reported acres (bottom row) across unit structures for individual-based plans (APH, YP, RP, and RP-HPE) from 2006 through 2025.

Source: NDSU Agricultural Risk Policy Center (ARPC) using data from USDA Risk Management Agency Summary of Business (transaction-level extract), as of October 15, 2026.

The commodity panels of Figure 7 also show how uneven the migration is: the Nut, Fruit, and Forage panels look nothing like Field Crops, retaining BU- and OU-heavy profiles throughout the window, a heterogeneity mapped state by state in Figure 9 below.

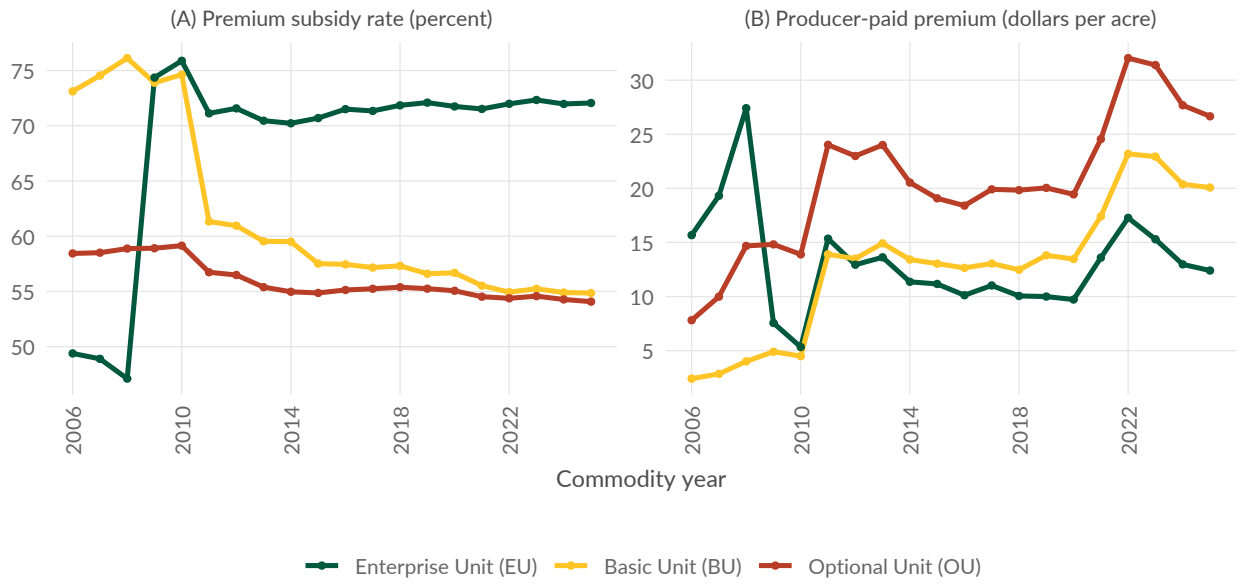
The shift toward EU is consistent with two complementary mechanisms, and the premium and subsidy data underlying the same policies make both visible. On the producer side, higher premium subsidies for EU reduce the producer-paid share of the premium relative to OU or BU, making EU enrollment more attractive, even though broader pooling means some localized losses may be absorbed before indemnities are triggered. On the actuarial side, broader aggregation reduces the variance of indemnified losses per insured acre, which is consistent with EU presenting lower underwriting risk to the program than more fragmented unit structures.

Figure 8 shows these incentives directly. The 2008 Farm Bill shift registers in panel A as a structural break: the EU subsidy rate leaps from below 50 percent to the mid-70s as the higher statutory subsidies took effect, and it has held near that level since, precisely the period over which the acreage migration in Figure 7 unfolds. In 2025, the premium subsidy rate averaged about 72.1 percent under EU, compared with 54.1 percent under OU and 54.9 percent under BU. The producer-paid premium per insured acre is correspondingly lower under the more aggregated structure: roughly $12 per acre under EU, versus $27 per acre under OU and $20 per acre under BU in 2025. The difference is large: the EU producer-paid premium per acre is about 53 percent lower than under OU and about 38 percent lower than under BU, savings of roughly $14 and $8 per acre, respectively. The gap reflects both the higher statutory subsidy factor applied to enterprise pooling and the lower premium rate per acre that broader aggregation earns, so a producer who consolidates acreage into an EU lowers out-of-pocket premium on two margins at once. These are descriptive averages across all individual-plan acres and do not net out differences in crop mix, coverage level, or geography across the three unit categories. Panel B also carries the commodity-price cycle: producer-paid premiums per acre climbed under all three unit structures to a peak in the early 2020s (above $30 per acre under OU) before easing, so the dollar gap between structures widens and narrows with prices even though the ranking, EU cheapest and OU most expensive, is stable throughout.

These descriptive cost differences align with estimated demand behavior. Enterprise-unit acreage appears to be the responsive margin in FCIP demand. In a decomposition of demand elasticities by unit structure, enterprise-unit acreage has a statistically significant extensive-margin elasticity of about -0.43 with respect to the producer-paid premium rate (an elasticity of -0.43 means that a 10 percent rise in the premium rate is associated with roughly a 4 percent reduction in enterprise-unit acreage). In contrast,

basic- and optional-unit acreage shows no statistically significant extensive-margin response (Tsiboe and Turner, 2023). The pattern is consistent with the acreage migration toward enterprise units documented in Figure 7, operating mainly through the extensive margin (that is, how many acres are drawn into the more aggregated, lower-cost structure) rather than through coverage depth. Because the reported elasticity is a national pooled estimate with respect to the premium rate, not the dollar-per-acre rate, it is best read as corroborating the direction of the incentive rather than scaling it.

Figure 8: ***Premium Subsidy Rate and Producer-Paid Premium per Acre by Unit Structure.***



Note: Panel A shows the premium subsidy rate, the share of total premium covered by the federal subsidy, and panel B shows the producer-paid premium per insured acre (total premium net of subsidy, divided by insured acres), each by unit structure for the All Crops aggregate of the five commodity groups, from 2006 through 2025. Both panels are restricted to individual-based plans (APH, YP, RP, and RP-HPE). Higher subsidy rates and lower producer-paid premiums per acre under Enterprise Units relative to Optional and Basic Units reflect the larger subsidy and lower rate per acre associated with broader pooling.

Source: NDSU Agricultural Risk Policy Center (ARPC) using data from USDA Risk Management Agency Summary of Business (transaction-level extract), as of October 15, 2026.

Recent work has shown that post-2008 subsidy changes reduced the adverse-selection penalty associated with finer unit structures by drawing acreage with a wider productivity range into the more aggregated EU category rather than concentrating lower-productivity or higher-risk acreage in OU or BU (Yu and Perry, 2024; Tsiboe et al., 2025b). The interpretation here remains descriptive: this report documents compositional shifts in unit-structure elections but does not estimate the marginal causal effect of subsidy changes on producers' choices.

Regional and Commodity-Group Patterns in Unit Structure Elections

Unit-structure choices also vary systematically across regions and commodity groups, reflecting differences in farm size, parcel layout, production practices, and the plans available for specific crop-county combinations. Figure 9 shades each state by its share of insured acres in each unit category and commodity group for individual-based plans in the 2025 crop year. Reading across the grid, the rows show the commodity groups and the columns show the three unit categories. Hence, each row displays how OU, BU, and EU partition acres within that commodity group. By construction, the three columns sum to 100 percent in each state-by-commodity-group cell.

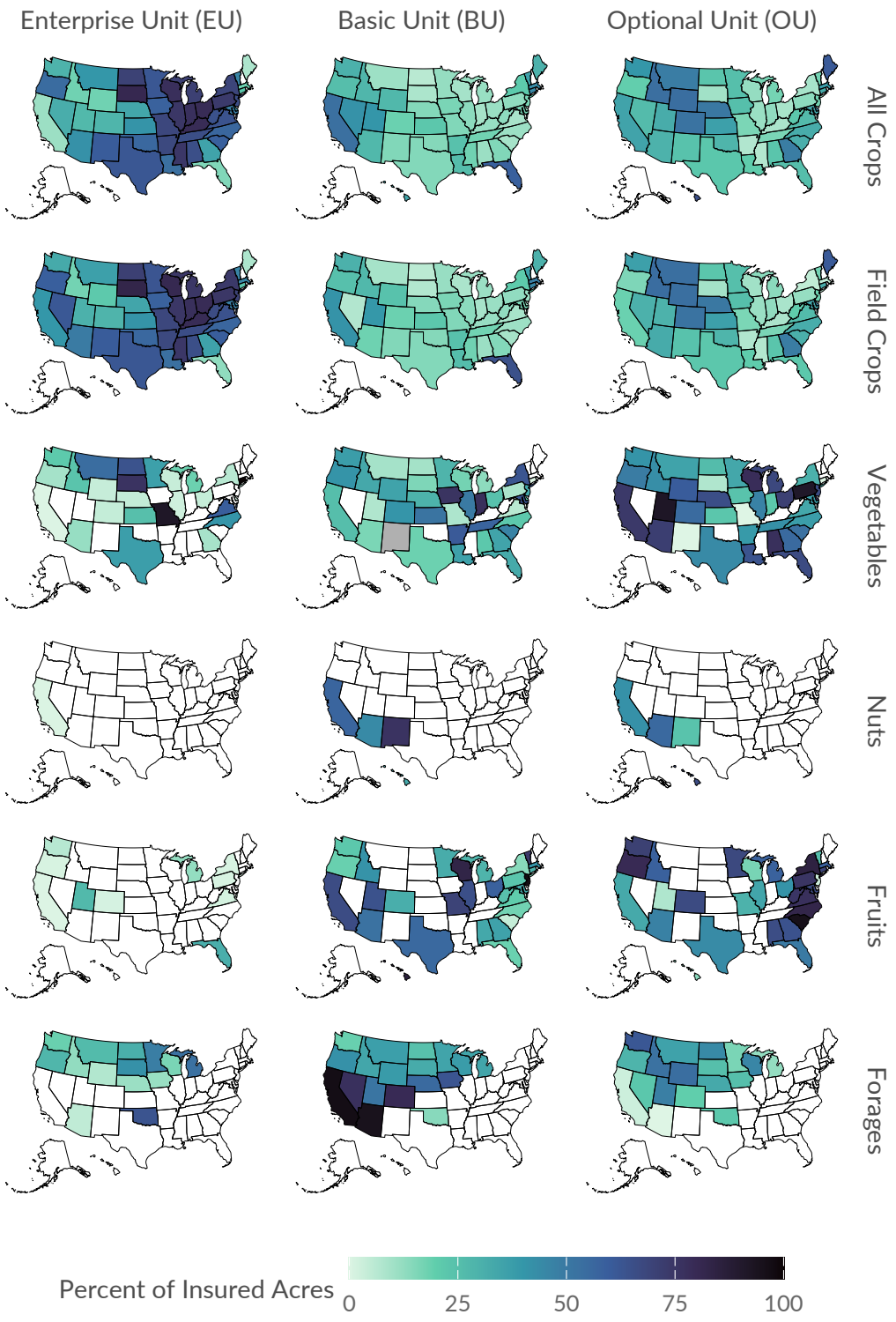
The EU column is darkest in the Field Crops row across the Midwest corn-soy belt. The Midwest field-crop EU share averages 63.7 percent, led by states such as South Dakota, Wisconsin, and Ohio. The Northeast and South field-crop EU shares average 71.4 percent and 61.5 percent, respectively, while the West field-crop EU share averages 33.6 percent. Across the All Crops row, the national EU share averages 63.4 percent in the Midwest and 30.4 percent in the West.

The BU column inverts much of that pattern. The BU share is highest in the Nuts row, where it averages 57.2 percent in the West, consistent with the orchard-ownership and crop-share conventions that bring multiple parcels under common share arrangements. In the Field Crops row, the Midwest BU share averages 13.1 percent, well below the West's 20.0 percent.

The OU column is darkest in the Vegetables row and, in the West, the Field Crops row, where parcel-level loss recognition continues to align with production geographies that EU pooling cannot easily span. The Midwest vegetable OU share averages 36.8 percent, the Northeast vegetable OU share averages 41.2 percent, and the West field-crop OU share averages 46.4 percent. The Fruits and Forages rows span the OU and BU columns roughly evenly, with the EU column uniformly light.

These commodity-by-region differences show that the national shift toward EU documented in Figure 7 is a weighted average of substantially more heterogeneous state- and commodity-level patterns. The row-crop core in the Midwest and eastern Plains accounts for most of the aggregate EU growth; many other commodity-region cells continue to rely on more disaggregated unit structures or have limited reported acreage by unit structure.

Figure 9: ***State by Commodity-Group Modal Unit Structure for Individual-Based Plans.***



Note: Each panel shades states by the share of insured acres carried by the indicated unit category in the corresponding commodity-group cell, restricted to individual-based plans (APH, YP, RP, and RP-HPE) for the 2025 crop year.

Source: NDSU Agricultural Risk Policy Center (ARPC) using data from USDA Risk Management Agency Summary of Business (transaction-level extract), as of October 15, 2026.

Two caveats are important for interpretation. First, unit-structure availability is not uniform across crop-county combinations. The set of units available to a producer depends on the plan, commodity, county, and, in some cases, production practice. Observed unit-structure shares therefore blend producer preference with the program's offer menu. Second, unit structure interacts with the plan and coverage-level elections discussed in later sections. The same nominal coverage level can imply different parcel-level loss-recognition thresholds under an EU than under an OU. The distributions reported here should therefore be read as descriptions of how risk is pooled across the program, not as a single-dimensional measure of insurance intensity.

Producer's Choice of Basic Insurance Plan

The insurance plan is the core FCIP election because it determines which risks are insured and what triggers a payment. A corn grower with YP is paid only when harvested bushels fall short of the guarantee; the same grower with RP is also paid when the harvest price falls, and RP even raises the guarantee if the harvest price rises above the projected price. Two plans can therefore carry the same coverage level yet protect very different outcomes. As summarized in Box 3 and Box 4, the FCIP menu spans individual yield and revenue policies, area-based and index-based products, whole-farm policies, dollar plans, and specialized products for specific commodities or production systems. The basic divide runs between products tied to the producer's own production or revenue history and products tied to outcomes measured over a broader geographic area or through an external index, a distinction that shapes both the nature of protection and the potential for basis risk (Tsiboe et al., 2023). Producers weigh how closely a plan tracks their farm outcomes against its fit with their risk profile, administrative simplicity, and the pricing of area- and index-based alternatives.

This section tracks insured liability and net reported acres across seven plan groups from 2006 to 2025, formed by consolidating the RMA basic plan codes along the divide between trigger level and protected outcome. **Individual Yield** covers individual-trigger yield plans, including APH, YP, and predecessor yield plans. **Individual Revenue** covers individual-trigger revenue plans, including RP, RP-HPE, Actual Revenue History (ARH), and historical revenue plans. **Whole-Farm** covers Whole-Farm Revenue Protection (WFRP) and the predecessor Adjusted Gross Revenue (AGR/AGR-L) plans. **Area Yield or Revenue** covers group-trigger yield and revenue plans, chiefly the Area Risk Protection Insurance (ARPI) family. **Rainfall Index** covers rainfall-index products, with Pasture, Rangeland, and Forage (PRF) dominating. **Dollar Index**

covers dollar-denominated plans, such as the Dollar Amount of Insurance (DOL), the Tree-Based Dollar Amount of Insurance (TDO), and the Aquaculture Dollar (AQDOL). **Other Index** covers the remaining group-, area-, and index-based products, such as vegetation-index plans and indexed Actual Production History. Figure 10 reports the distribution of insured liability and net reported acres across these plan groups.

Box 3: Selected Basic Individual-Experience Insurance Plans

- **Yield-based plans:**
  Actual Production History (APH) insures a selected share of the producer's approved yield history, usually from 50 to 85 percent, although some areas have lower maximums. The guarantee is converted to dollars using the elected price.
  Yield Protection (YP) also insures yield shortfalls, but generally uses projected prices determined from futures market settlement prices or other approved pricing mechanisms.

- **Revenue-based plans:**
  Actual Revenue History (ARH) uses historical revenue rather than historical yield and includes crop-specific provisions related to yield, price, or quality outcomes.
  Revenue Protection (RP) covers revenue losses arising from yield shortfalls, price declines, or a combination of both. In addition, RP uses the higher of the projected or harvest price in setting the final guarantee, which gives protection against upside price movement when production falls.
  Revenue Protection with Harvest Price Exclusion (RP-HPE) is similar to RP except that it does not include upside harvest price protection. The guarantee remains tied to the projected price.

- **Whole-Farm Revenue Protection (WFRP):** WFRP insures revenue for the entire farm under one policy. It covers revenue losses from natural causes and market price declines and is the successor to the Adjusted Gross Revenue (AGR) program. WFRP may be purchased as a standalone whole-farm policy or alongside individual Multi-Peril Crop Insurance (MPCI) policies (YP, RP, or RP-HPE) on individual crops, in which case the per-crop indemnities under the underlying policies count against the WFRP whole-farm revenue guarantee.

- **Crop and Livestock Income Protection (CLIP):** CLIP is an umbrella revenue insurance plan that works in conjunction with two or more underlying RP policies in the same county. Rather than insuring one crop or livestock commodity independently, CLIP combines the insurable value of the covered RP policies and protects up to 85 percent of the combined value. Each underlying RP policy remains in force and continues to determine its own crop-specific guarantee and indemnity. CLIP then provides an additional county-level income protection layer when the combined revenue outcome across the covered commodities falls below the CLIP guarantee. Because CLIP depends on two or more RP policies, it is most relevant for diversified producers with multiple qualifying crops or livestock commodities. It differs from WFRP because it is tied to selected underlying RP policies rather than the producer's whole-farm historic revenue.

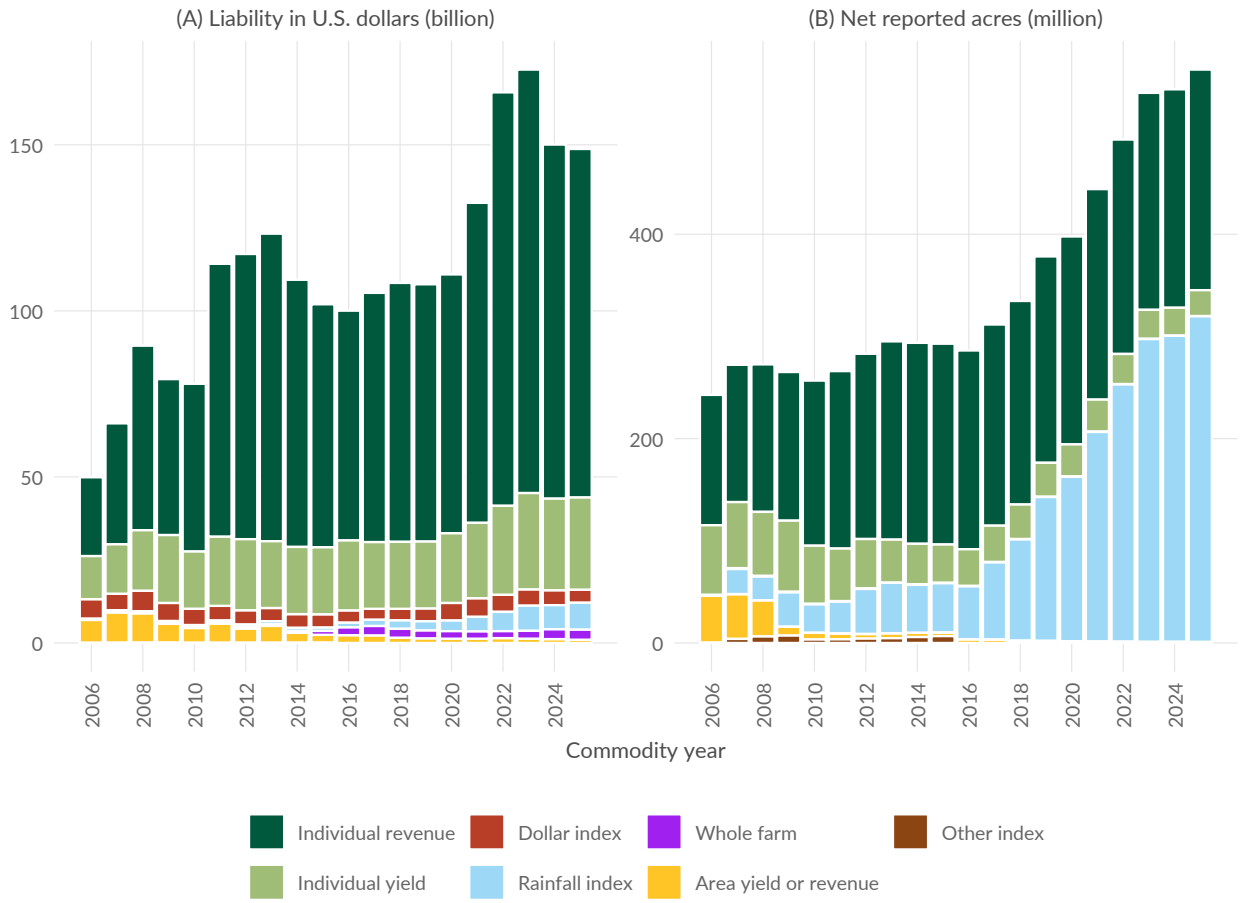
Box 4: Selected Basic Group-Experience Insurance Plans

- **Dollar Amount of Insurance (DOL) plans:**
  These plans base guarantees on the cost of establishing the crop rather than on expected yield or revenue. Examples include **Dollar Amount of Insurance (DOL)**, **Fixed Dollar Amount of Insurance**, and **Tree-Based Dollar Amount of Insurance (TDO)**.
- **Area Risk Protection Insurance (ARPI):**
  ARPI provides coverage based on county-level outcomes rather than individual farm performance. Producers can select **Area Revenue Protection**, **Area Revenue Protection with Harvest Price Exclusion**, or **Area Yield Protection**.
- **Margin Protection (MP):** MP insures against an unexpected decline in operating margin, defined broadly as revenue minus certain input costs. Like ARPI, it is area-based and relies on county-level measures to determine guarantees and indemnities. MP may be purchased as a standalone basic policy or as a supplemental endorsement layered on a YP, RP, or RP-HPE policy on the same crop; the distinction matters because the standalone form sits alongside the basic policy while the supplemental form sits above the underlying coverage band.
- **Pasture, Rangeland, Forage (PRF):** PRF is designed for perennial pasture, rangeland, and forage acreage used for livestock feed. It is index-based and relies on precipitation measures rather than farm-level production.

The Plan-Group Composition of Liability and Acres

Liability and acres tell complementary stories about how producers use the program. In 2025, Individual Revenue plans carry 70.6 percent of insured liability and Individual Yield plans carry 18.6 percent, so the two individual-experience families together account for the large majority of program liability. The five remaining groups each hold a small share: Area Yield or Revenue at 0.7 percent, Rainfall Index at 5.5 percent, Dollar Index at 2.7 percent, and Whole-Farm at 2.0 percent, while the residual Other Index group has reported no liability since 2015. In dollar terms, Individual Revenue accounts for roughly $104.9 billion of insured liability in 2025. RP and RP-HPE dominate corn, soybeans, wheat, and cotton, and the combination of high per-acre prices and high coverage levels in those crops translates into a large dollar share of liability even when the corresponding share of insured acres is closer to the program average.

Figure 10: ***U.S. Federal Crop Insurance Liability and Acreage by Insurance Plan Group.***



Note: Plan groups consolidate RMA insurance plan abbreviations: Individual Yield includes Grower Yield Certification (APH), Tobacco (Quota) (TQ), Actual Production History (APH), Grower Yield Certification Span (APH), Tobacco (Guaranteed Production) (TGP), Yield Protection (YP), and Production Revenue History - Yield (PRH-Y); Individual Revenue includes Income Protection (IP), Revenue Assurance (RA), Crop Revenue Coverage (CRC), Avocado Revenue Coverage (ARC), Peanuts (PNT), Pecan Revenue (PRV), Actual Revenue History (ARH), Revenue Protection (RP), Revenue Protection with Harvest Price Exclusion (RP-HPE), Production Revenue History - Plus (PRH-P), Production Revenue History - Revenue (PRH-R), and Crop and Livestock Income Protection (CLIP); Area yield or revenue includes Group Risk Protection (GRP), Group Risk Income Protection (GRIP), Indexed Income Protection (IIP), Yield Based Dollar Amount of Insurance (YDO), Group Risk Income Protection - Harvest Revenue Option (GRIP-HRO), Group Risk Plan (GRP), Area Revenue Protection (ARP), Area Revenue Protection - Harvest Price Exclusion (ARP - HPE), and Area Yield Protection (AYP); Dollar index includes Dollar Amount of Insurance (DOL), Tree Based Dollar Amount of Insurance (TDO), Fixed Dollar Amount of Insurance (DOL), Dollar Amount of Insurance (DO), and Fixed Dollar Amount of Insurance (FD); Whole farm includes Adjusted Gross Revenue - Lite (AGRLT), Adjusted Gross Revenue (AGR), Adjusted Gross Revenue - Lite (AGR-L), and Whole Farm Revenue Protection (WFRP); Rainfall index includes Rainfall Index (RAINF), and Rainfall Index (RI); and Other index includes Vegetation Index (VEGAT), Actual Production History - Indexed (IAPH), and Vegetation Index (VI). Livestock policies are excluded. Acreage is taken from the Summary of Business acre quantities and excludes quantities reported on a tree, plant, or dollar basis. FCIP data are based on the Risk Management Agency Summary of Business as of October 15, 2026.

Source: NDSU Agricultural Risk Policy Center (ARPC) using data from USDA Risk Management Agency Summary of Business, as of October 15, 2026.

The acreage picture differs sharply from the liability picture. In 2025, the Rainfall Index group carries 56.8

percent of net reported acres (about 318.7 million acres), reflecting the very large enrolled area of PRF. Individual Revenue plans account for 38.5 percent of insured acres, and Individual Yield plans for 4.5 percent, while Area Yield or Revenue and Dollar Index account for 0.2 and 0.1 percent, respectively. The per-acre liability of the Rainfall Index group is very low compared with row-crop revenue plans, roughly $25 per insured acre in 2025 against about $486 per acre for Individual Revenue plans, so its dollar share of program liability is far smaller than its acreage share. ARPI adds further area-based acres in specific commodity-region combinations (standalone Margin Protection (MP) acreage is not included in the plan-group exhibit). Still, PRF accounts for nearly all of the index-based acreage trend.

The time-series in Figure 10 shows three sustained shifts from 2006 to 2025. First, the Individual Revenue share of insured liability increased from 47.6 percent at the start of the window to 70.6 percent in 2025, both because revenue products are the default election for major row crops and because per-acre liability in those crops has risen with commodity prices and coverage levels. Second, the Individual Yield share of insured acres moved from 28.0 percent to 4.5 percent as more row-crop acreage has migrated into revenue products. However, yield plans remain important in commodities and regions where revenue products are not offered. Third, the Rainfall Index acreage share rose to 56.8 percent, almost entirely through the PRF; this expansion is the principal reason the acreage panel of Figure 10 looks compositionally different from the liability panel. These compositional shifts play out against a nominal-liability cycle that is plainly visible in panel A: total insured liability crested at roughly $173 billion in 2023 and stands at about $149 billion in 2025, an easing that tracks commodity prices coming off their post-2021 highs rather than any retreat in participation, since insured acres continued to grow through the same years.

The migration from yield toward revenue products is consistent with estimated demand behavior across plan types. Decomposing FCIP demand elasticities by protection type, recent work finds opposing extensive-margin responses to the cost of insurance: revenue-protection acreage carries a statistically significant elasticity of about -0.54 with respect to the producer-paid premium rate, while yield-protection acreage carries a statistically significant positive elasticity of about +0.48 (Tsiboe and Turner, 2023). The positive yield-plan response is consistent with substitution, as some acreage priced out of, or shifting away from, revenue coverage is retained under lower-cost yield coverage rather than dropped. This pattern corroborates the compositional shift documented here and is not a causal estimate produced by this report; the interpretive limits noted for the unit-structure elasticity in Section 4 apply here as well.

Whole-farm coverage merits separate attention even though its share of program totals is small.

Following the 2014 Farm Bill, the RMA consolidated the legacy AGR plans into WFRP in 2015. WFRP insures the producer's whole-farm revenue under a single policy, accommodates diversified operations that include commodities without their own Multi-Peril Crop Insurance (MPCI) offering, and may be purchased on its own or layered alongside individual MPCI policies on specific crops. Where WFRP is layered with individual MPCI policies, indemnities under the per-crop policies count against the whole-farm guarantee. In 2022, RMA introduced Micro Farm as a simplified whole-farm option for smaller diversified operations. In the data underlying Figure 10, Whole-Farm liability reached its highest level, roughly $3.0 billion, in 2025.

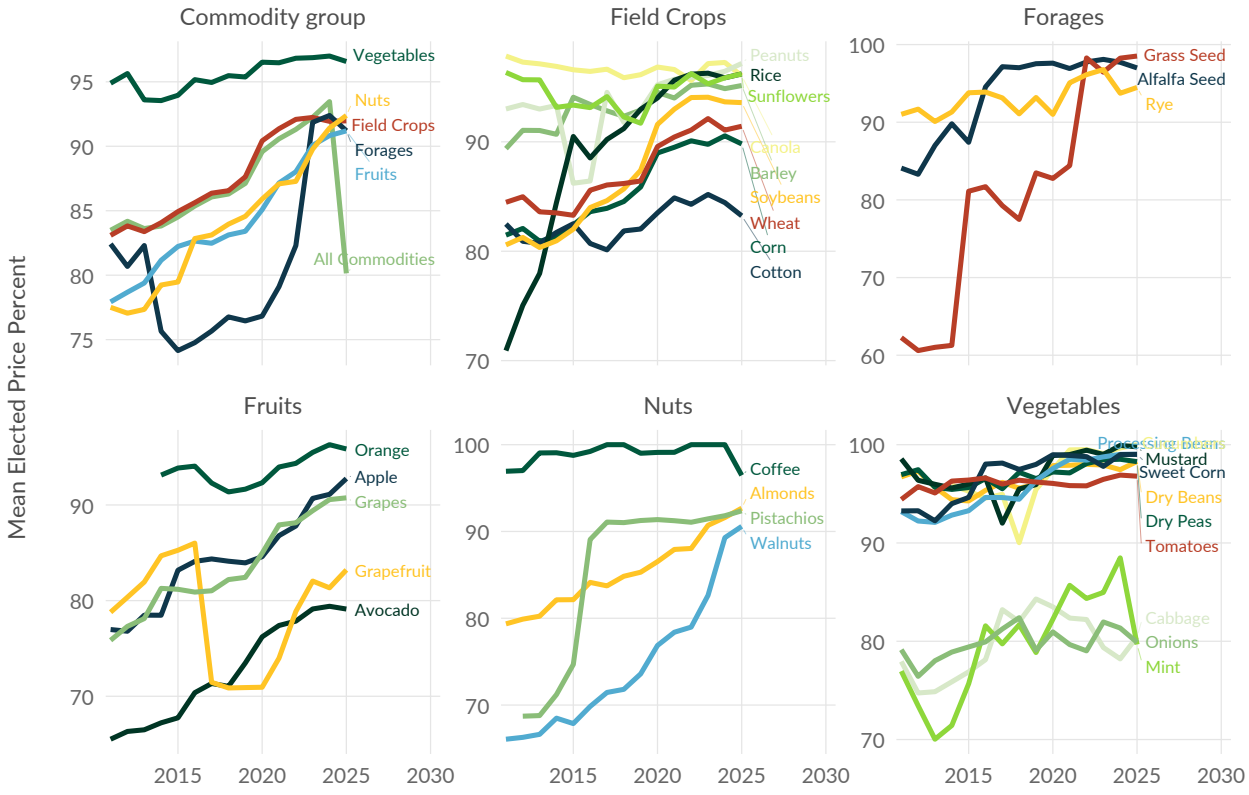
Because plan availability varies systematically by commodity and county, the distribution in Figure 10 is best read as the joint product of producer preferences and the program's offer menu rather than as a single intensity index (Whitt et al., 2023; Gaku and Tsiboe, 2025). The same producer may elect different plans for different crops in the same operation, and a producer in a county where revenue products are unavailable for a given crop is restricted to yield-based or area-based alternatives. Index-based plans, including PRF, also operate on a different loss-measurement principle from individual yield or revenue plans, which is important for interpreting their large acreage footprint: the index measures rainfall in a grid cell rather than the producer's own forage outcomes, and indemnities reflect departures of the index from its historical distribution rather than verified on-farm losses (Tsiboe et al., 2023; Chalise et al., 2017). Supplemental and companion endorsements that producers layer on top of these basic plans are documented separately in Box 8 and discussed in Section 8.

Election Price Percent

For yield-based policies, producers also choose the share of the projected price to insure, which converts the insured production quantity into a monetary guarantee. This election does not change the quantity insured; rather, it determines the dollar value attached to that quantity for liability and indemnity calculation. Revenue-based plans treat price differently. Under RP, the revenue guarantee may increase when the harvest price exceeds the projected price. At the same time, RP-HPE does not allow this upward adjustment. Thus, in revenue insurance, price is used not only to value output but also to determine the structure of revenue risk protection, including downside price protection, similar to a put option. Because revenue-based plans fix the treatment of price by contract design, the producer-elected price percent is structurally 100 percent on those plans and varies only on Individual Yield plans (YP and APH). The discussion below, Figure 11, and Figure 12 are therefore restricted to Individual Yield plans.

Figure 11 reports the acre-weighted mean elected price percent on Individual Yield policies from 2011 through 2025, at the program level and for each commodity group's leading commodities. Program-wide, the mean elected price percent rose from roughly 83 percent in 2011 to 93 percent in 2024, before registering 80 percent in 2025; because current-year records are still accumulating as of the data date, the final-year value should be read as preliminary and may partly reflect the changing commodity composition of reported policies rather than a change in producer behavior. In 2025, the commodity-group means run from 91 percent (Fruits) to 97 percent (Vegetables), and the commodity-level panels show that down-election is concentrated in particular commodities (among leading commodities, Avocado records the lowest mean at about 79 percent) while means close to 100 percent indicate that nearly all producers in the commodity elect the full projected price.

Figure 11: ***Producer's Election of Price Percent under Individual Yield Plans, by Commodity.***



Note: Time-series of the mean elected price percent under Individual Yield plans (Yield Protection and Actual Production History), weighted by insured acres, from 2011 through 2025. The price percent election determines the dollar value attached to the insured production quantity. Producers under Individual Yield plans elect a share of the projected price ranging from 60 to 100 percent in 5-point increments; a mean below 100 percent indicates down-election by some subset of producers in the commodity. Revenue-based plans are excluded because the contract design fixes price and the elected price percent is structurally 100 percent for those plans.

Source: NDSU Agricultural Risk Policy Center (ARPC) using producer-level data from the USDA Risk Management Agency FCIP Policy Acceptance and Storage System, as of May 5, 2026.

Differences across commodity groups and across major commodities within each group reflect both commodity-specific contract design and the heterogeneity of producer election patterns within commodities that allow a discount from the full projected price. The economics of the election parallel the coverage-level choice: because the elected price percent scales the liability on which the premium is computed, electing less than the full projected price lowers the premium along with the guarantee, so down-election functions as a cost lever for producers who want yield protection without paying for the full dollar valuation of the crop.

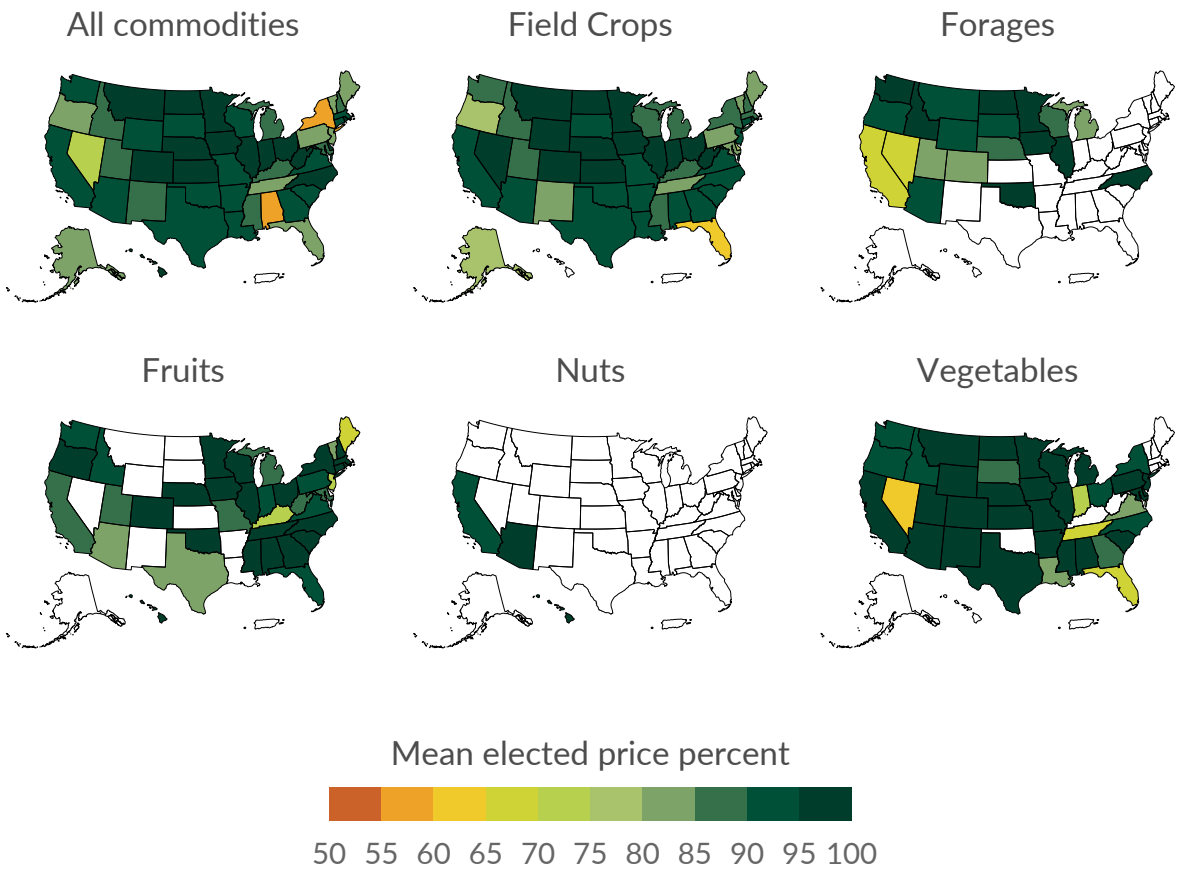
The geography of price-percent elections mirrors the commodity patterns. Figure 12 maps the 2025 state-level means for the program and for each commodity group. Mean elections are lowest (near 56 percent in Alabama) in states whose Individual Yield books are dominated by fruit, vegetable, and other specialty commodities where down-election is common, and sit at or near 100 percent across the Plains and Corn Belt, where the yield-plan book is dominated by major field crops insured at the full projected price. Because the price percent scales liability directly, this geography implies that two states with similar insured acreage under Individual Yield plans can carry systematically different liability per acre purely through the price election margin, a further reason, alongside the share-of-interest patterns, to interpret cross-state liability comparisons with care.

Producer's Choice of Coverage Level

Coverage level is the producer's choice of how much of the expected outcome to guarantee under the selected insurance plan. It is one of the most visible dimensions of FCIP policy design because it determines the threshold at which indemnities begin and the amount of protection provided. As explained in Box 5, the guaranteed outcome may be yield or revenue, depending on the plan. Under a yield plan, the coverage level fixes the guaranteed share of the producer's approved yield history; under a revenue plan, it fixes the guaranteed share of expected revenue. CAT coverage is the minimum level and generally protects only against severe losses, while buy-up coverage allows producers to purchase higher levels of protection in increments.

For coverage-level distributions, the unit of analysis is the commodity-year-by-coverage-level band. Coverage levels are collapsed into six bands: CAT, 50–55 percent, 60–65 percent, 70–75 percent, 80–85 percent, and 90–95 percent.

Figure 12: ***Producer's Election of Price Percent under Individual Yield Plans, by State and Commodity Group.***



Note: State-level means of the elected price percent under Individual Yield plans (Yield Protection and Actual Production History), weighted by insured acres, in 2025. A mean of 100 percent indicates that producers elect the full projected price; lower means indicate down-election by some subset of producers. Revenue-based plans are excluded because the contract design fixes price and the elected price percent is structurally 100 percent for those plans.

Source: NDSU Agricultural Risk Policy Center (ARPC) using producer-level data from the USDA Risk Management Agency FCIP Policy Acceptance and Storage System, as of May 5, 2026.

Coverage levels should be interpreted carefully across plan families. A 65 percent yield policy and a 65 percent revenue policy do not guarantee the same outcome, even though they share the same nominal coverage level. Similarly, RP and RP-HPE differ in how they treat harvest-price movements. Box 5 provides a numerical example of these differences. Because of this non-comparability, the coverage-level distribution is reported by band and should be read primarily within, rather than across, plan groups.

For regional and commodity-group breakdowns, the unit of analysis is the state-by-commodity-group-by-period observation, restricted to individual-based plans: APH, YP, RP, RP-HPE, and ARH.

Box 5: What Does X Percent Coverage Mean?

A crop insurance policy guarantees a selected share of expected yield or expected revenue. Producers choose this share when they select a coverage level. For example, if expected yield is 100 bushels per acre and the producer selects 75-percent coverage, the policy guarantees 75 bushels per acre. A revenue policy instead guarantees a share of expected revenue. Although two policies may have the same coverage level, they do not necessarily provide the same guarantee. Yield and revenue policies protect different outcomes and are therefore priced differently.

Consider two otherwise identical producers, each with 100 acres of corn, an expected yield of 100 bushels per acre, and a projected price of $6 per bushel. Expected revenue is therefore $60,000. Suppose both producers select 65 percent coverage and actual yield falls to 50 bushels per acre.

- **Scenario 1: Harvest price falls below the projected price:** If the harvest price falls to $5, pre-insurance revenue is $25,000. Under a yield policy such as YP or APH, the producer is guaranteed 6,500 bushels in total, or 65 bushels per acre. Because actual production is only 5,000 bushels, the shortfall equals 1,500 bushels. Valued at the projected price of $6, the indemnity equals $9,000, bringing total revenue to $34,000. Under a revenue policy, the guarantee is based on expected revenue. With 65 percent coverage, the guaranteed revenue under RP-HPE is $39,000. Since actual revenue is $25,000, the indemnity is $14,000, and total revenue becomes $39,000. In this declining-price example, RP and RP-HPE produce the same guarantee because the harvest price is below the projected price.

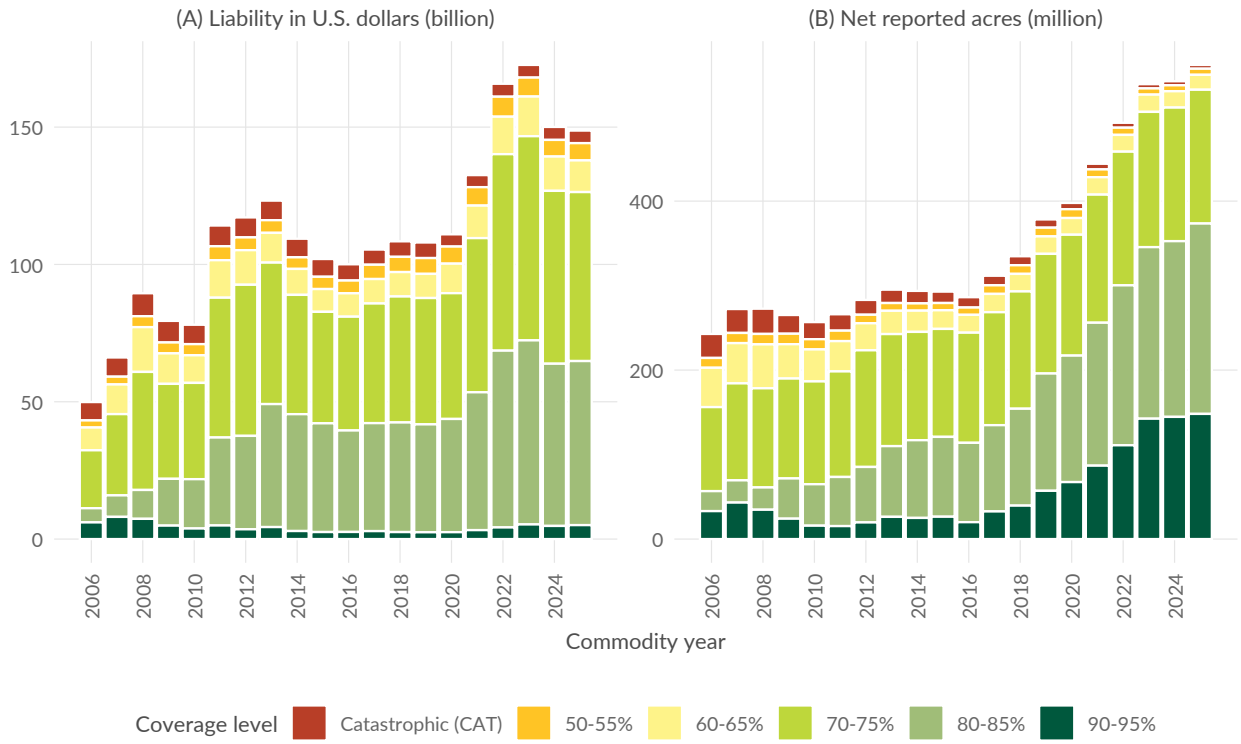
- **Scenario 2: Harvest price rises above the projected price:** If instead the harvest price rises to $7, pre-insurance revenue becomes $35,000. For the yield policy, the indemnity does not change because the guarantee is still based on the insured yield shortfall valued at the projected price. The indemnity remains $9,000, and total revenue rises to $44,000 because the harvested bushels are now sold at the higher harvest price. For **RP**, the guarantee is recalculated using the higher of the projected or harvest price. The resulting guarantee is $45,500. With pre-insurance revenue of $35,000, the indemnity equals $10,500, yielding total revenue of $45,500. For **RP-HPE**, the guarantee remains tied to the projected price. It therefore stays at $39,000. Given pre-insurance revenue of $35,000, the indemnity is $4,000, and total revenue is $39,000. This example shows that identical coverage percentages do not imply identical protection. A 65 percent yield policy guarantees a share of expected yield, while a 65 percent revenue policy guarantees a share of expected revenue. In addition, RP and RP-HPE differ because RP can increase the guarantee when harvest prices rise, whereas RP-HPE does not.

These scenarios describe payouts, not what the producer pays for them. Coverage is not free: raising the coverage level, or moving from a yield to a revenue policy, raises the premium. Federal subsidy offsets part of that premium, but the subsidy rate generally falls at the higher coverage levels (Table 1), so the producer-paid share of the premium climbs faster than the coverage level itself. The plan and coverage-level election therefore trades greater protection against a higher producer-paid premium, a cost dimension the payout scenarios above do not show.

Bands and Time-Series Composition

Producers have moved steadily up the coverage scale over the analytic window, and Figure 13 shows where the acres and dollars went: it reports how insured liability and net reported acres distribute across the six coverage-level bands defined above, from 2006 to 2025. The nominal-liability crest of the early 2020s noted in Section 5 is visible in panel A here as well; it reflects the commodity-price cycle rather than enrollment and does not alter the compositional story that follows.

Figure 13: ***U.S. Federal Crop Insurance Liability and Acreage by Coverage-Level Band.***



Note: Bars show total FCIP insured liability (panel A) and net reported acres (panel B) by year and coverage-level band from 2006 through 2025. Coverage levels are grouped into six bands: Catastrophic (identified through the RMA catastrophic-delivery flag), 50-55, 60-65, 70-75, 80-85, and 90-95 percent of the elected yield or revenue guarantee. Because yield and revenue policies guarantee different things, a 75 percent coverage level is not directly comparable across plans (see the coverage box in the body of the report). Livestock policies are excluded. FCIP data are based on the Risk Management Agency Summary of Business as of October 15, 2026.

Source: NDSU Agricultural Risk Policy Center (ARPC) using data from USDA Risk Management Agency Summary of Business, as of October 15, 2026.

Three sustained shifts are visible in Figure 13. First, the Catastrophic share of insured acres moved from 11.7 percent at the start of the window to 0.8 percent in 2025, with the CAT share of liability changing

from 13.4 percent to 3.1 percent over the same period. The administrative fee that producers pay for CAT coverage was increased in the 2018 Farm Bill, which is one of several factors associated with the continued contraction of CAT participation since that point.[1] Second, the 50-55 and 60-65 percent buy-up bands have receded as a share of insured acres and liability: the 50-55 acreage share moved from 4.8 percent to 1.3 percent, and the 60-65 acreage share from 19.2 percent to 3.1 percent.

Third, the bands at 70 percent and above have expanded on net, with the growth concentrated in the top two bands. The 80-85 band's share of insured acres moved from 9.7 percent to 40.1 percent and the 90-95 share from 13.6 percent to 26.4 percent, while the 70-75 share moved from 41.0 percent to 28.2 percent as acreage migrated further up the coverage scale. In dollar terms, the 70-75 liability share is 41.4 percent of program liability in 2025, the 80-85 share is 40.2 percent, and the 90-95 share is 3.4 percent. Taken together, bands at 70 percent and above now account for 94.8 percent of insured acres, up from 64.3 percent at the start of the window, and 84.9 percent of program liability in 2025. The acreage at the 90-95 band is far larger than its liability share because it includes area- and index-based plans (chiefly PRF) that are offered at high nominal coverage but carry low liability per acre; this is the strongest instance of the plan-family caveat noted above, and the reason band shares overstate buy-up intensity at the top of the scale.

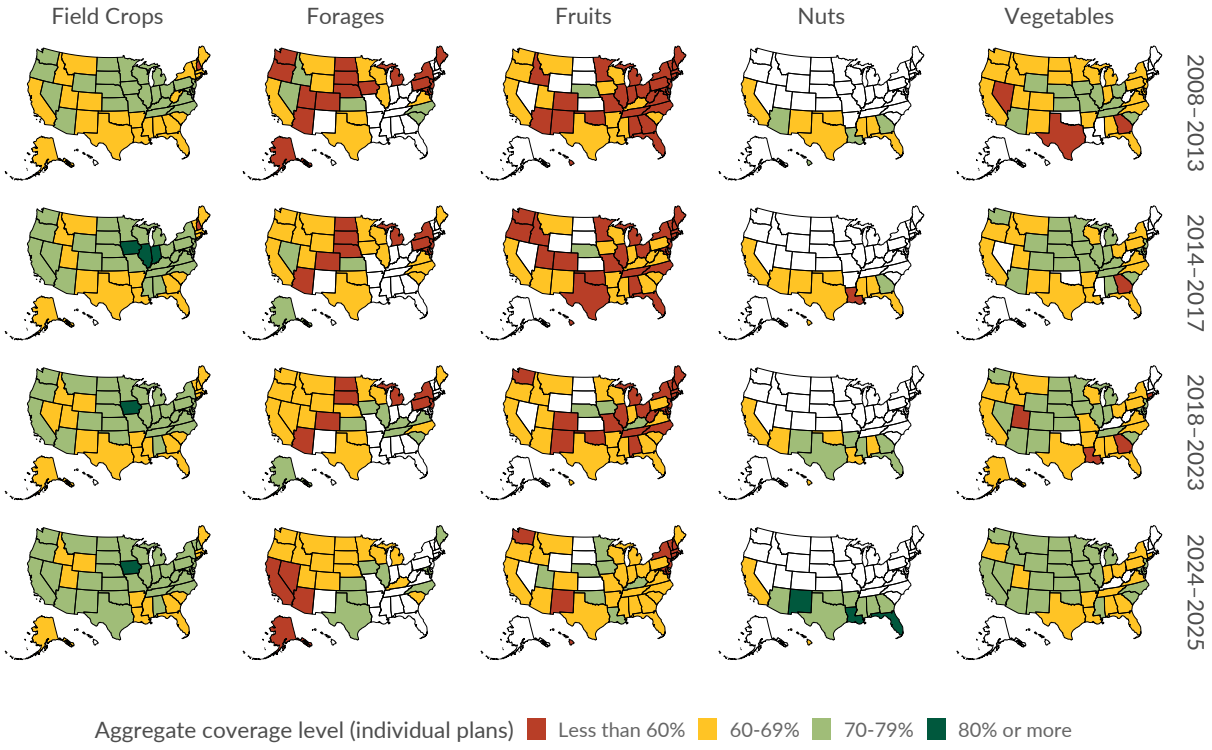
The maximum coverage level available varies by commodity, county, and plan. APH, YP, RP, and RP-HPE coverage in many counties tops out at 85 percent, and some commodity-county combinations have lower maximums; these can also be paired with supplemental endorsements (Box 8, discussed in Section 8) that extend effective protection into the 86-to-95 percent range. Index- and area-based plans, including PRF and ARPI, can be offered at coverage levels up to 90 or 95 percent depending on the plan and crop. As a result, the observed share at the 80-85 and 90-95 bands reflects both producer preferences and the structure of the offer menu: a region in which the upper bands are not available will show no acreage at those bands regardless of producer demand.

[1] This association is descriptive only; the report does not isolate the marginal effect of the 2018 CAT administrative-fee change on CAT participation.

Geographic and Commodity-Group Patterns

The aggregate coverage-level distribution masks pronounced variation across regions and commodity groups. To summarize the geographic pattern, Figure 14 reports the binned aggregate coverage level (insured liability divided by potential liability) for individual-based plans by state, commodity group, and time period. The aggregate measure is used because the elected-coverage-level mean is not directly comparable across commodities with different available coverage menus.

Figure 14: ***State by Commodity-Group Aggregate Coverage Level for Individual-Based Plans.***



Note: Each map shades states by the binned aggregate coverage level for basic insurance plans. Aggregate coverage level is defined as the ratio of total insured liability to total potential liability (liability divided by elected coverage-level percent) in the state-commodity-period cell, which is comparable across commodities with different available coverage menus. Catastrophic coverage is excluded.

Source: NDSU Agricultural Risk Policy Center (ARPC) using data from USDA Risk Management Agency Summary of Business, as of October 15, 2026.

Figure 14 rewards being read down its columns as much as across its rows: the four period-rows show

aggregate coverage ratcheting upward over two decades, most visibly in the specialty groups, where fruit and forage maps that open the window shaded predominantly below 60 percent warm toward the 60-to-69 band and above by 2024–2025, and where the nut maps fill in as individual-plan offerings spread. In the 2024–2025 period, the dominant aggregate coverage band on field crops is 70 to 79 percent in every region; within the Midwest, Iowa stands out, with field-crop producers in the 80 percent or higher band in the same period. For vegetables, the dominant band is 70 to 79 percent in the Midwest and West; 60 to 69 percent in the Northeast and South. Nut coverage is concentrated in the South (70 to 79 percent) and West (60 to 69 percent), where most nut acreage is located. Fruit coverage remains the lowest of the major commodity groups, with the dominant band at 60 to 69 percent in the Midwest, South, and West; below 60 percent in the Northeast. For forage, the dominant band is 60 to 69 percent in the Midwest and West; 70 to 79 percent in the Northeast and South; within that pattern, Kansas forage producers register 70 to 79 percent in the same period.

These commodity-by-region patterns reinforce a recurring theme of the report: the program-level coverage distribution is the weighted average of substantially different patterns across commodity groups and regions, and it should be interpreted alongside the structural differences in product availability and per-acre liability that shape those patterns.

Producer's Choice of Basic Policy Options and Endorsements

Choosing an insurance plan, a coverage level, and a unit structure does not fully specify an FCIP policy. A further layer of elections, the basic policy options, adjusts how the underlying guarantee is built, how acreage is treated, and how indemnities are calculated. These options work from within the basic policy, changing its terms rather than adding to it, which distinguishes them from the supplemental coverage products examined in Section 8 that sit on top of the basic policy as a separate layer.

The menu of these elections has widened considerably. The ICE catalog records 66 distinct option codes in the 2025 crop year, up from 40 in 2011, the earliest year the catalog covers. Producers can now tailor a policy to the particular risk, agronomy, and recordkeeping of a crop rather than accept coverage as a fixed package. The eight functional categories that organize the menu are summarized in Box 6 and Box 7, spanning adjustments to the yield history that anchors the guarantee, prevented-planting and replanting provisions, quality and price adjustments, and crop-specific and named-peril endorsements.

Box 6: Basic Policy Option Categories (1 of 2)

Basic policy options are administrative elections that modify how an underlying FCIP policy's guarantee is constructed, how acreage is treated, or how indemnities are paid. They are distinct from supplemental coverage products, which add a separate layer above the basic policy and are described in Section 8. The Risk Management Agency Insurance Choice Election (ICE) catalog records 66 distinct option codes for the 2025 crop year, organized into 8 functional categories shown in Figure 1. This box presents the first 4 categories; the remaining 4 continue in the next box. Each option is listed by name with its RMA option code in parentheses.

- **Yield and APH History Adjustments.** Change how the Actual Production History (APH) database, and for revenue policies the corresponding revenue guarantee, is constructed. These elections modify the recorded yield history that determines the policy guarantee. Options offered in 2025: Personal T Yield (PY); Revenue Cup 90% (RC); Revenue Exclusion (RX); Trend Adjustment (TA); Yield Adjustment 60% (YA); Yield Cup (YC); Yield Exclusion (YE).
- **Planting and Replanting Options.** Modify how acreage is treated when planting is prevented or when replanting becomes necessary, including elections that raise the prevented-planting coverage factor or recognize crop-rotation practices. Options offered in 2025: 2 Yr Crop Rotation (CR); Crop Replacement Endsmnt (RP); Early Harvest Option (EH); Prevented Planting +5% (PF); Replant Exclusion (RE); Stage Removal (NS).
- **Quality, Grade, and Marketability Options.** Adjust how harvested production with degraded quality, off-grade output, or alternative end-uses is counted against the policy guarantee. Options offered in 2025: Fresh Option (AF); Malting Endorsement (ME); Pear Quality Adj (PQ); Processing Quality (PR); Quality Exclusion (QX); Quality Loss (QL); Quality Option #1 (QA); Quality Option #2 (QB); Quality#2/Fresh (QC); Quality#2/Processing (QD).
- **Commodity-Specific Endorsements.** Address risks and contract features that arise only for specific commodities or production systems (trees, perennials, organic operations, quarantined commodities, seed crops, and similar narrow contexts). Options offered in 2025: CRE Opt B:NO Depreciation (RD); Certified Seed (CL); Certified Seed High (CH); Comprehensive Tree Value (CV); Coverage Enhancement (CE); Downed Commodity Endsmnt (DC); Dual Use (DU); EU by Cropping Prac (EC); EU by Irrigation Prac (EI); EU by Organic Prac (EO); EU by Type (ET); Fire Blight (FB); Fire Blight and CV (FC); Fire Blight and OLO (FL); Fire Blight, CV and OLO (FX); Olo Base Policy (OW); Olo Ctv Endorsement (OX); Peak Endorsement (PE); Quarantine Endorsement (QE); Seed Endorsement (SE); Storage (ST).

Figure 15 reports for each category, the most-elected options by 2025 insured acres alongside the category's share of all insured option-acres. The distribution is highly concentrated. Adjustments to the yield and APH/production history account for 25.2 percent of insured option-acres in 2025, more than all other categories combined, though they make up only 76 of the options on the menu. Four elections anchor that category: Yield Adjustment, the single most-elected option at roughly 235.2 million insured

acres (24.7 percent of option-acres), and Yield Cup at about 230.9 million acres (24.2 percent), followed by Trend Adjustment at roughly 157.4 million acres (16.5 percent) and Yield Exclusion, authorized by the 2014 Farm Bill, at about 86.7 million acres (9.1 percent). The remaining categories are far smaller: planting and replanting options, quality and marketability options, and unit administrative sub-elections (the residual grouping) account for 7.5, 6.1, and 1.6 percent of option-acres respectively, with price and revenue options at 2.7 percent and crop-specific endorsements, weather-and-peril protections, and coverage exclusions each carrying smaller shares.

Box 7: Basic Policy Option Categories (2 of 2)

Continued from the previous box: the remaining 4 of the 8 functional categories of basic policy options offered in 2025. Each option is listed by name with its RMA option code in parentheses.

- **Weather and Peril-Specific Protections.** Extend coverage for named weather perils that the standard policy does not fully cover, such as frost, freeze, tropical storms, and winter conditions. Options offered in 2025: Freeze Protection (FZ); Protective Covering (PC); Tropical Storm (TS); Winter Coverage (WO); With Frost Protection (FR).
- **Coverage Exclusions and Restrictions.** Remove designated acreage or perils from the insured pool, including the exclusion of high-risk land, hail and fire perils, and acreage without an approved weed-control program. Options offered in 2025: Hail & Fire Exclusion (HF); High-Risk Land Exclusion (HB); Short Rate Adjustment (SR); Unit Division by Grid Opt (UG); Without Weed Control (WC).
- **Price and Revenue Options.** Modify how the price component of the guarantee is set, including substituting alternative price values, electing floor or minimum-value provisions, or layering price endorsements. Options offered in 2025: Contract Pricing (CP); Coverage Level by Irr Prac (LP); Floor Option 100% (FO); Floor Option 90% (FN); Hybrid Seed Price Endorse (HS); Minimum Value Option (VO); Minimum Value Option I (VA); Minimum Value Option II (VB); Producer Price Option (PS); Revenue Substitution 60% (RS).
- **Other.** Refine which acres are insurable as a single unit or under which subsidy rules, including subdivisions of basic and enterprise units, multi-county enterprise units, and short-rate adjustments. These elections shape how acreage is administered rather than how the guarantee is constructed. Options offered in 2025: BU by NonContiguous Land (BL); Multi-County EU (MC).

These options modify the underlying APH, yield, revenue, or production guarantee; the treatment of acreage; or the calculation of indemnities. They are distinct from supplemental coverage products (SCO, ECO, STAX, HIP-WI, PACE), which add a separate layer of coverage above the basic policy and are documented in Section 8.

This concentration says something about how producers manage risk. Yield Adjustment, Yield Cup, Trend Adjustment, and Yield Exclusion all act on the approved yield that sets the policy guarantee, not on the

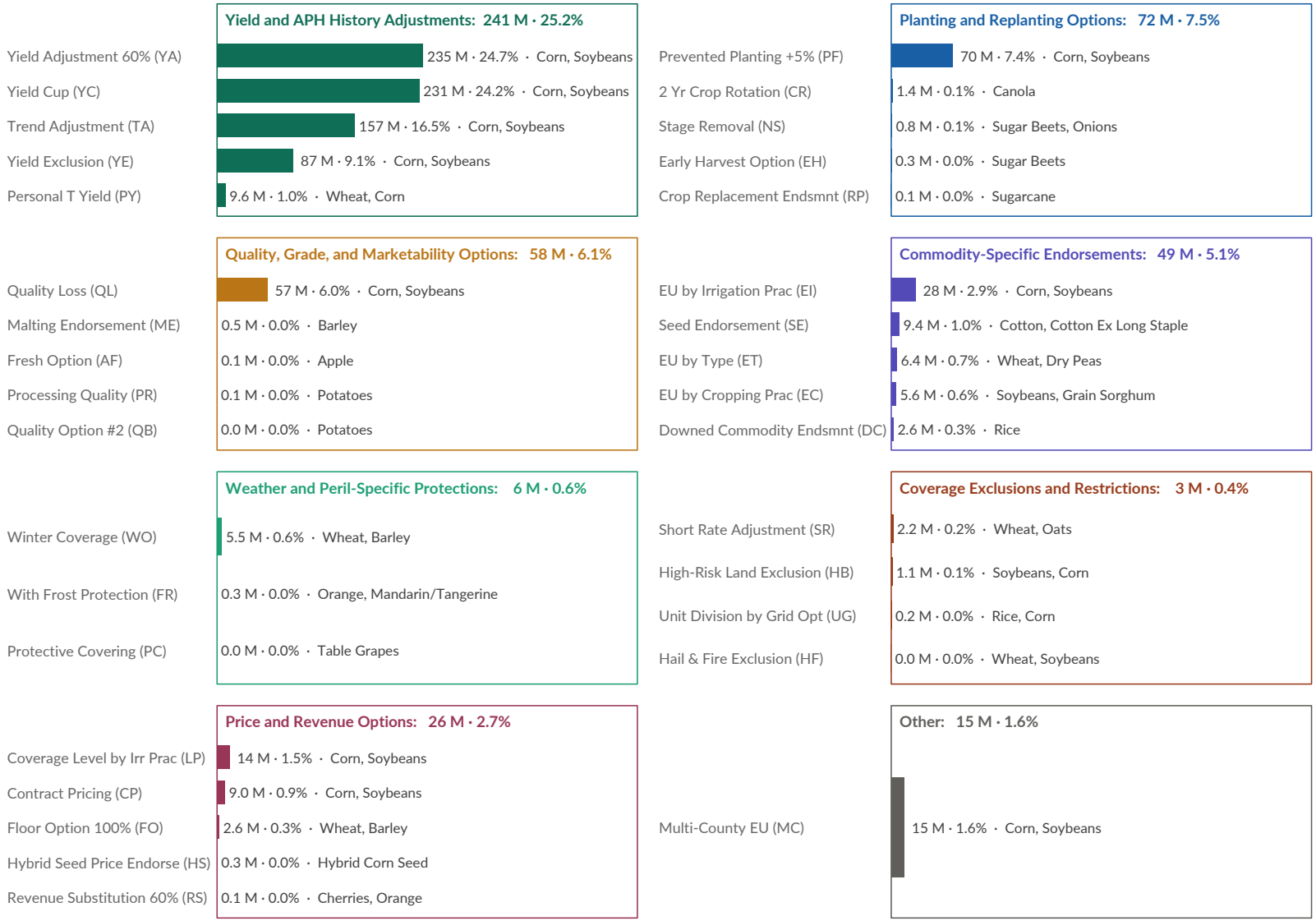
coverage percentage. Their prominence indicates that, across the large row-crop book where they apply, producers actively manage the *level* of the guarantee (the yield the policy is built on) and not only the share of that yield they choose to insure. These elections support or raise the effective guarantee without changing the nominal coverage level, so a policy's coverage percentage alone can understate the protection a producer has assembled.

Figure 15 also labels each option with the crops on which it is most used, and the menu sorts in an orderly way: each category concentrates where the risk it addresses is concentrated. Yield-history adjustments, the largest category at 240.9 million insured option-acres in 2025, cluster in Corn, Soybeans, and Wheat, where long Actual Production History records and established county yield trends make Trend Adjustment and Yield Exclusion both available and worthwhile. Planting and replanting options (71.8 million acres) follow a similar geography, concentrating in Corn, Soybeans, and Wheat, where prevented-planting exposure is greatest. Nearly all of that category is one election: the 5 percentage-point prevented-planting buy-up (PF), at roughly 70 million insured acres, the largest single option outside the yield-history category. It is also the buy-up the EARP final rule phases out over the 2026 and 2027 crop years, so the PF acreage recorded here is the population whose protection that change removed for 2026; USDA has since committed on July 21, 2026, to restoring the buy-up, pending formal RMA guidance, so its ultimate status remains unsettled (see Section 9) (Chakravorty et al., 2026). Quality, grade, and marketability options (58.0 million acres) shift toward crops whose value turns on condition or grade, led by Corn, Soybeans, and Wheat.

Crop- and commodity-specific endorsements (49.0 million acres) appear in the perennial and specialty commodities they were designed for, chiefly Cotton, Soybeans, and Corn, while weather and peril-specific protections (5.8 million acres) concentrate in Wheat, Orange, and Mandarin/Tangerine. Coverage exclusions and restrictions (3.4 million acres) concentrate where high-risk land or hail and fire perils dominate, led by Wheat, Soybeans, and Corn. The menu is not a uniform set of add-ons applied evenly across the program; it is a crop-specific toolkit whose use follows the underlying agronomy, the maturity of each crop's yield records, and the particular perils a commodity faces.

Three features of the data shape how far these shares can be pushed. Options are not mutually exclusive: one policy can carry several at once, so acres summed across options exceed total insured acreage, and the shares here describe composition *within* elected options rather than participation rates against eligible acres. Option availability also varies by crop, county, and practice, so observed shares reflect both producer preference and what is offered in a given location.

Figure 15: *Basic Policy Options Reference Panel, by Category.*



Note: Bars show the top five options in the category by insured acres in 2025; the label gives insured acres in millions, the share of insured option-acres, and the leading crops by acres for that option. The category header gives the category total insured acres and its share of insured option-acres. Because options are not mutually exclusive, acres sum across options to more than total insured acreage, so shares are composition within elected options rather than participation rates.

Source: NDSU Agricultural Risk Policy Center (ARPC) using data from USDA Risk Management Agency Summary of Business participation extract and Insurance Choice Election catalog, as of October 15, 2026.

With those qualifications, the takeaway is clear. A small number of yield-history elections, concentrated in the row-crop core, quietly raise the guarantees on a large share of insured acres. At the same time, the rest of the menu functions as targeted protection matched to specific crops and perils. The options layer is therefore a low-visibility but consequential part of how producers build coverage, one that also indicates how changes to yield-history rules or to the option menu would propagate through the program.

Producer's Choice of Supplemental Coverage

Supplemental products are the optional final layer of an FCIP policy. As summarized in Box 8, the main supplemental products in use over the 2015 to 2025 window are the SCO, the ECO, the Stacked Income Protection Plan (STAX), the Hurricane Insurance Protection-Wind Index (HIP-WI), the Post-Application Coverage Endorsement (PACE), and MP when elected as an endorsement rather than as a standalone basic plan. From the producer's perspective, they are the final step in a layered risk-management strategy: after settling on a unit structure, basic insurance plan, coverage level, and price-and-share election, the producer decides whether and how much of the residual loss exposure to insure through these add-ons.

Supplemental products do not stand alone in the way a basic policy does. Except for STAX on upland cotton, each requires an underlying individual-based policy (APH, YP, RP, or RP-HPE) and pays only within the *deductible region* of that policy: the band of loss between the producer's elected coverage level and 100 percent of the expected outcome that the basic policy leaves uninsured. Within that band, the products fall into two broad types. *Single-peril* endorsements, such as the HIP-WI, the PACE, and the Fire Insurance Protection-Smoke Index (FIP-SI), insure one specific named cause of loss rather than the full deductible. *Multi-peril* endorsements insure the same broad set of perils as the underlying policy, in a higher band, and divide into two tiers: a first tier, led by the SCO, that runs from the underlying coverage level up to 86 percent (rising to 90 percent for the 2027 crop year and beyond); and a second tier, led by the ECO and the Margin Coverage Option (MCO), that runs from the top of the first tier up to 95 percent. Because each tier occupies a defined slice of the deductible, a producer can stack a first- and second-tier endorsement on the same policy to insure progressively more of the retained loss.

Box 8: Selected Supplemental Endorsements

Supplemental endorsements provide additional coverage within the *deductible region* of an underlying individual-based policy (APH, YP, RP, or RP-HPE), that is, the band of loss between the elected coverage level and 100 percent of the expected outcome, and typically trigger on area or index measures rather than individual farm losses. They are of two broad types. *Multi-peril* endorsements cover the same perils as the underlying policy in a higher band, occupying two tiers: a first tier running from the underlying coverage level to 86 percent (90 percent from the 2027 crop year) and a second tier running from there up to 95 percent. *Single-peril* endorsements cover one specific named cause of loss. Although **Margin Protection (MP)** is listed above as a basic plan, it may also function alongside certain underlying individual plans.

- **Supplemental Coverage Option (SCO):** First-tier multi-peril endorsement available with APH, YP, RP, or RP-HPE; covers the deductible from the producer's underlying coverage level up to 86 percent (90 percent from the 2027 crop year).
- **Enhanced Coverage Option (ECO):** Second-tier multi-peril endorsement that extends protection above the first tier, generally up to 90 or 95 percent depending on the elected level.
- **Margin Coverage Option (MCO):** Second-tier multi-peril endorsement that, like ECO, covers the upper portion of the deductible up to 95 percent, but is written on a margin basis (revenue net of certain input costs) rather than on yield or revenue alone.
- **Stacked Income Protection Plan (STAX):** Area-revenue multi-peril plan for upland cotton; may be purchased either alone or alongside another policy.
- **Hurricane Insurance Protection-Wind Index (HIP-WI):** Single-peril endorsement that covers part of the deductible when a county or adjacent county experiences sustained hurricane-force winds. A Tropical Storm option may also be available.
- **Post-Application Coverage Endorsement (PACE):** Single-peril endorsement that pays when adverse weather and field conditions prevent a producer from making a qualifying post or split nitrogen application during specified corn growth stages.
- **Fire Insurance Protection-Smoke Index (FIP-SI):** Single-peril, county-index endorsement that covers part of the deductible on the Grape Crop Provisions when the insured county records a qualifying number of FCIC-determined smoke events; individual vineyard outcomes are not assessed, and it may be combined with SCO or the Catastrophic Risk Protection Endorsement. For the 2026 crop year, it is offered for grapes in California, Idaho, Oregon, and Washington.

Supplemental Acreage by Commodity Group

Supplemental acreage varies systematically by commodity group, reflecting differences in product availability, the underlying risk being insured, and the producer economics of layering coverage on top of a basic policy. Figure 16 shows insured acres under each supplemental product from 2015 through 2025 for the five commodity groups discussed in this report. Field crops, which account for the largest share of U.S. cropland, exhibit the most layered structure: ECO, SCO, HIP-WI, and STAX together cover most of the supplemental footprint in this group, and ECO participation in particular began climbing almost immediately after the product became available in 2021. Across all insured commodities, ECO carried about 62 million insured acres in 2025, up from roughly 7 million in 2021 and far ahead of SCO (12 million), HIP-WI (11 million), and STAX (1.2 million). The sharp step-up in the 2025 bars across the panels is discussed at the end of this section, where the subsidy changes behind it are examined.

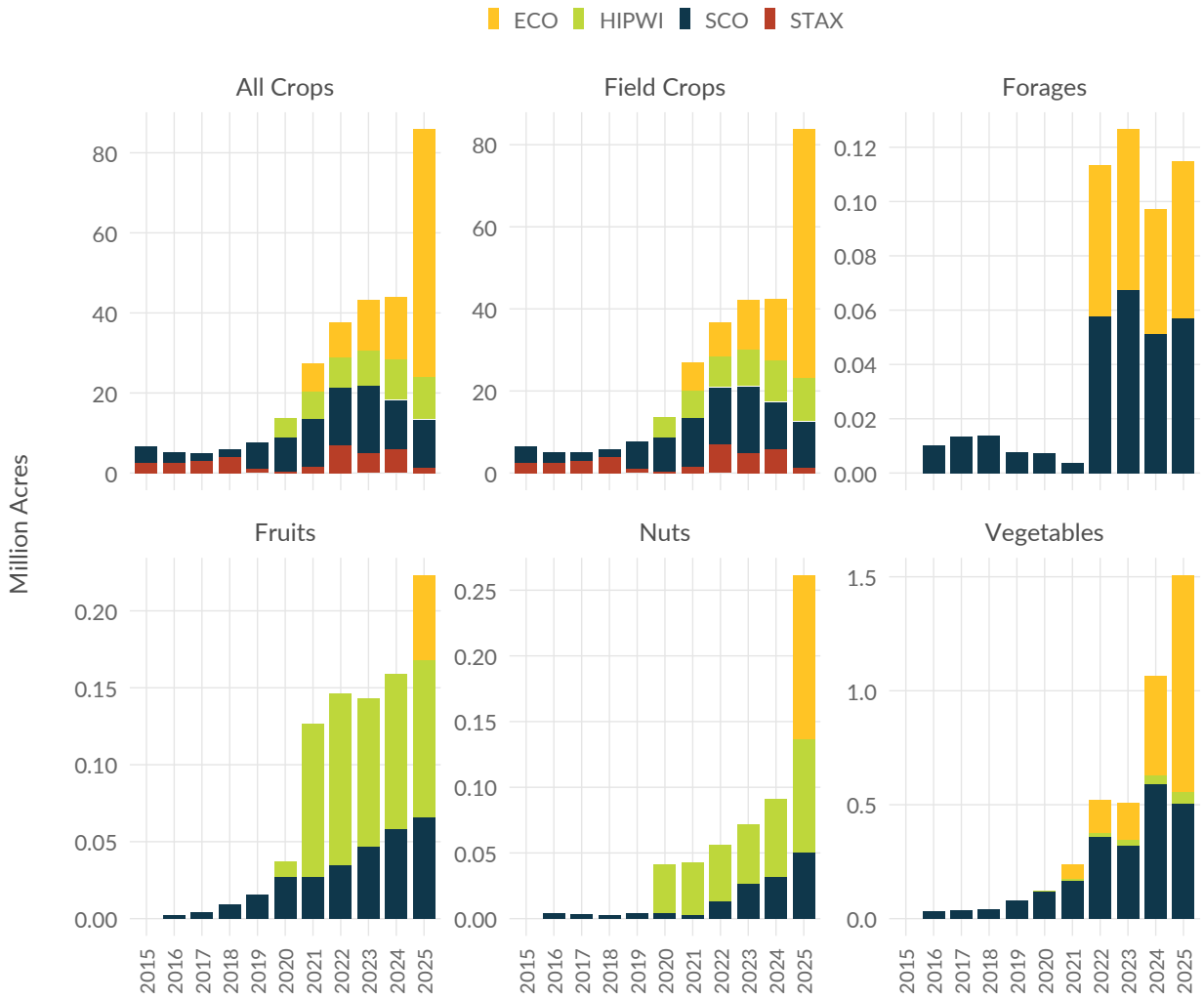
Fruits and nuts show a different pattern: these labor-intensive industries operate on a small share of total cropland and are geographically concentrated in coastal states such as California, Florida, and Washington; in those groups, HIP-WI accounts for a relatively larger share of supplemental acreage, reflecting the hurricane and named-storm exposure that the product is designed to insure. ECO was not extended to several fruit and nut commodities until the 2025 crop year, so early supplemental participation in those groups skews more toward SCO than it does in field crops. Vegetables and forage show much lower supplemental acreage in absolute terms, and the supplemental products that do appear in those groups (chiefly SCO and small ECO acreage in recent years) reflect the narrower set of commodity-county combinations where supplemental coverage is actually offered.

County-Level Adoption Patterns

Underlying the commodity-group totals is the county-by-county pattern of where each supplemental product is eligible, where it is actually offered, and where producers elect it. Figure 17 reports that county-level adoption for the four most-elected supplemental products (SCO, ECO, HIP-WI, and STAX) at three time points: the inception year for each product, the prior year, and the current year. Adoption is measured as the share of eligible insured acreage enrolled in the supplemental plan, where eligibility requires both a qualifying basic policy (APH, YP, RP, or RP-HPE for SCO and ECO; upland cotton acreage for STAX; hurricane-exposed counties for HIP-WI) and the supplemental product actually being offered in the county. Counties that lack the required basic policy or where the product is not offered are shaded

distinctly from counties where adoption is simply low.

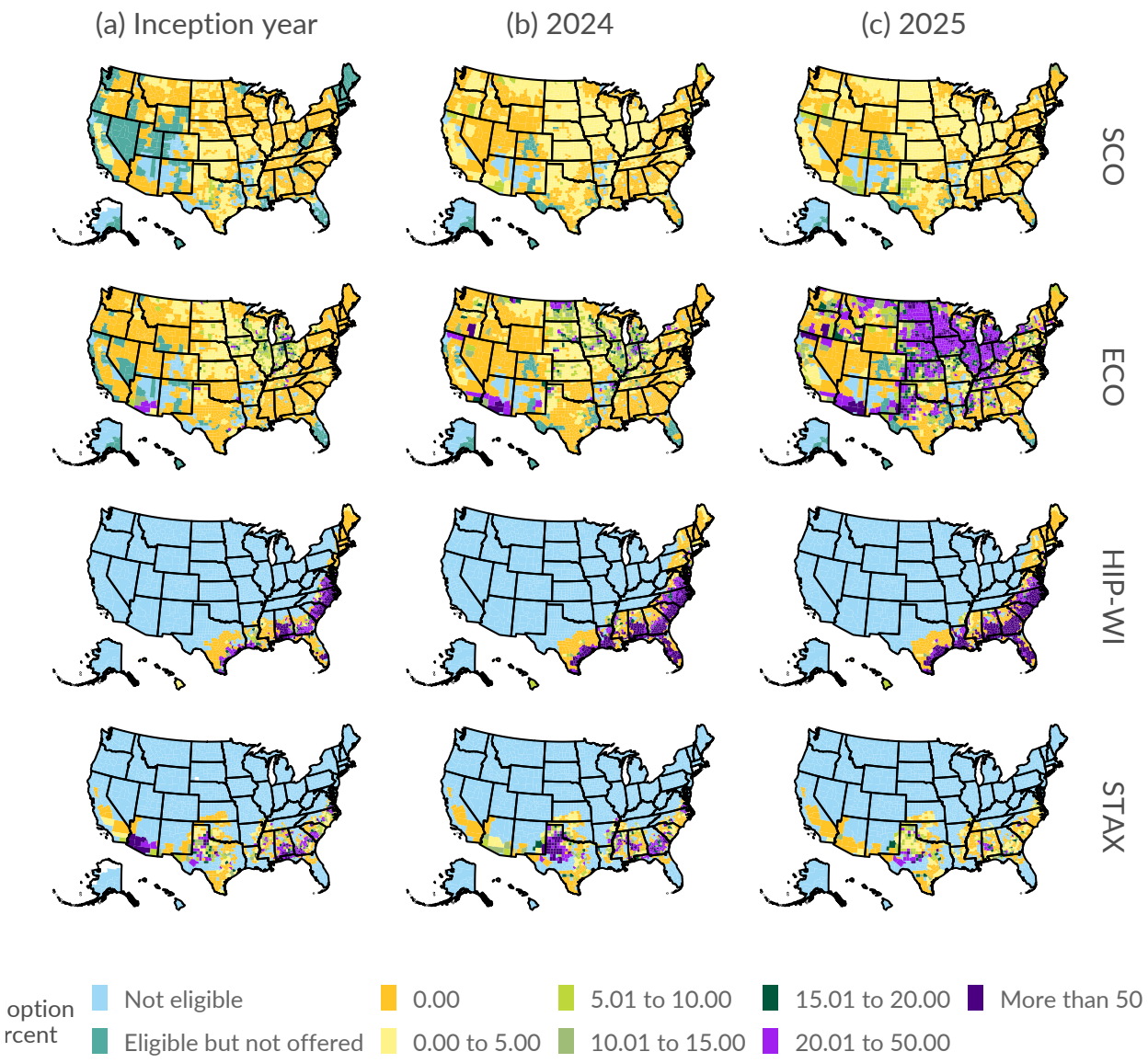
Figure 16: ***Supplemental Insurance Use by Commodity Group from 2015 to 2025, Insured Acres in Millions.***



Note: Field crops include wheat, canola, oats, millet, rice, cotton, flax, sugarcane, sugar beets, corn, popcorn, safflower, hybrid sorghum seed, sorghum, cultivated wild rice, hybrid corn seed, peanuts, sunflowers, hybrid seed rice, soybeans, potatoes, barley, buckwheat, triticale, tobacco, sesame, and hemp. Fruits include the output (and where applicable the trees) for blueberries, avocados, peaches, prunes, grapes, apples, cranberries, strawberries, tangerine trees, grapefruit, lemons, tangelos, orange trees, grapefruit trees, lemon trees, lime trees, all other citrus trees, avocado trees, oranges, banana, papaya, papaya tree, mandarins/tangerines, and tangors. Nuts include the output (and where applicable the trees) for pecans, macadamia nuts, macadamia trees, almonds, walnuts, coffee, coffee tree, and pecan trees. Forages include forage production, rye, grass seed, and alfalfa seed. Vegetables include onions, sweet corn, fresh market sweet corn, processing beans, dry beans, green peas, dry peas, mustard, cabbage, mint, clary sage, peppers, fresh market tomatoes, tomatoes, fresh market beans, cucumbers, pumpkins, and sweet potatoes. All crops include all the listed crops above and all other commodities not specified.

Source: NDSU Agricultural Risk Policy Center (ARPC) using data from USDA Risk Management Agency Summary of Business, as of October 15, 2026.

Figure 17: ***Supplemental Coverage Offering and Adoption in the U.S. Federal Crop Insurance Program from 2015 to 2025.***



Note: This figure illustrates county-level eligibility, availability, and adoption for four supplemental products: Supplemental Coverage Option (SCO), Enhanced Coverage Option (ECO), Stacked Income Protection Program (STAX), and Hurricane Insurance Protection - Wind Index (HIP-WI). County eligibility requires the relevant basic policy (APH, YP, RP, or RP-HPE for SCO and ECO; upland cotton for STAX; hurricane-exposed counties for HIP-WI). The left column of each row displays the first year in which each product became available (2015 for SCO; 2021 for ECO; 2015 for STAX; 2020 for HIP-WI). Shading distinguishes counties that are ineligible, eligible but not offered, or adopting the product, with adoption measured as the share of eligible insured acres enrolled in the respective supplemental plan.

Source: NDSU Agricultural Risk Policy Center (ARPC) using data from USDA Risk Management Agency Summary of Business, as of October 15, 2026.

Through 2024, supplemental adoption remained modest across most counties: a large share of eligible counties enrolled less than 5 percent of eligible insured acreage in supplemental coverage. Where adoption did occur, it was concentrated in regions dominated by major row crops (the Heartland, the Northern Great Plains, the Mississippi Portal, and the Western Prairie Gateway) where county-level outcomes tend to track individual-farm outcomes more closely and the basis risk of an area-triggered product is relatively low (Chalise et al., 2017). SCO uptake was relatively slow following its 2015 introduction, while ECO posted faster first-year adoption after its 2021 introduction. ECO adoption grew faster because its upper-layer coverage triggers at more moderate losses than SCO. Although ECO has a higher premium per dollar of liability, its cost per dollar of expected indemnity is generally lower, encouraging producers to add it to existing RP or YP coverage.

Recent Subsidy Changes and Adoption Trends

The 2025 crop year reshapes the picture, and the current-year column of Figure 17 records it. Following the administrative increase in the ECO premium-subsidy rate (Risk Management Agency [RMA], 2024), ECO adoption rose sharply across the Heartland and Northern Plains, with many field-crop counties moving from low-single-digit shares to enrollment above 20 percent of eligible acres, and some counties exceeding 50 percent. SCO adoption also expanded in counties where it had already been established (the Texas Cotton Belt, Southern Idaho and Oregon, and the Northern Plains), although across most of the Heartland SCO shares remain below 10 percent of eligible acres. HIP-WI, after its slower initial uptake in 2020, gained traction as producers in hurricane-prone counties observed the product's performance following Beryl, Debby, Francine, Helene, and other named storms; the automatic, county-triggered indemnity release (over $1.69 billion in aggregate from 2020 to 2025 under HIP-WI and its Tropical Storm Option) aligned indemnities with observed storm exposure, and adoption in affected counties now exceeds 50 percent of eligible acreage. STAX adoption, by contrast, has remained low and largely flat over the same period. Because the plan is available only for upland cotton, its footprint is confined to the cotton-growing South and Southwest. It has not broadened with the subsidy and offer changes that lifted SCO and ECO, leaving it the smallest of the four most-elected supplemental products by insured acres. Section 9 returns to this layer, tracing how the OBBB-mandated subsidy lift extends the 2025 shifts documented here into the 2026 and 2027 crop years.

Outlook for Producer Choices

The report up to this point documents how U.S. producers configured FCIP policies through the 2025 crop year. Two confirmed actions are large enough to reshape that baseline going forward and rest on enough evidence to discuss in detail. The One Big Beautiful Bill Act (OBBB), signed on July 4, 2025, raises premium subsidies on two separate margins of the policy: the unit-structure margin (Basic and Optional Unit rates, which pull the Enterprise Unit schedule up with them) and the supplemental layer above the basic policy (Turner and Arita, 2025). The Expanding Access to Risk Protection (EARP) final rule, issued by RMA on November 28, 2025, removes prevented-planting buy-up coverage, phasing in over the 2026 and 2027 crop years as each crop's contract change date passes (Risk Management Agency [RMA], 2025a; Chakravorty et al., 2025). Several narrower confirmed RMA actions also modify the 2027 election menu; Appendix B catalogs those, and they are not analyzed here. For each of the two changes below, the discussion identifies what the change does, what the empirical literature implies about the likely direction of producer response, and what would still be speculative to claim; it does not estimate the marginal causal effect of any single change.

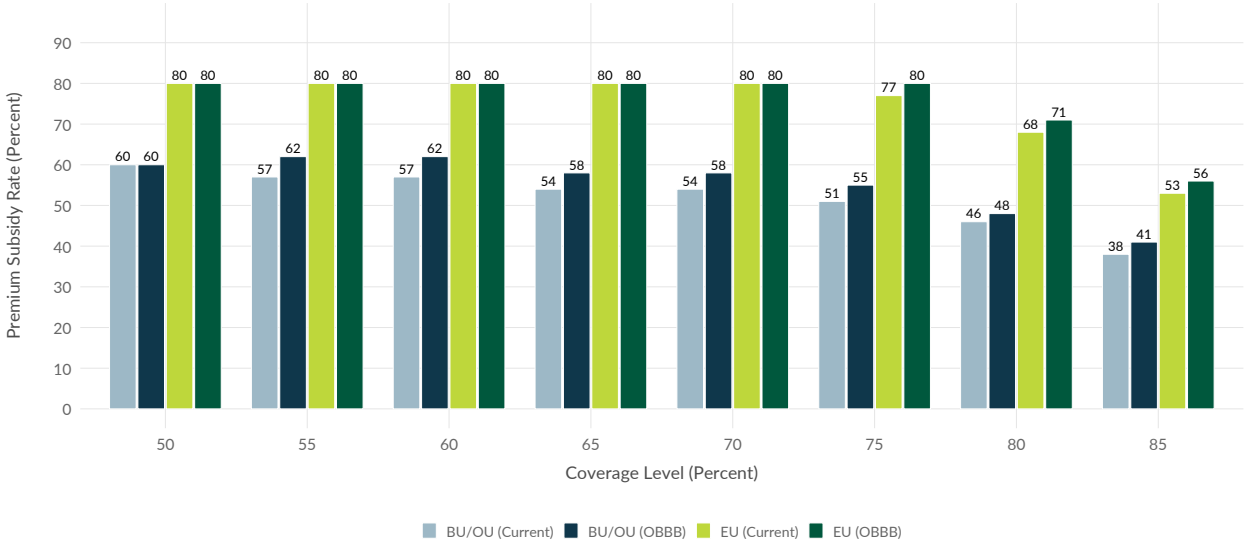
OBBB and the Unit-Structure Margin

The OBBB delivers the first increase in Basic and Optional Unit premium subsidies since 2000, and it lands squarely on the unit-structure margin Section 4 documented. Figure 18 reports the published premium subsidy schedule for BU and OU alongside the EU schedule, comparing the 2025 rates in effect before the change with the 2026 rates that carry it. The 2026 schedule raises BU and OU subsidies by roughly three to five percentage points across the 55 through 85 percent coverage levels while leaving the 50 percent rate essentially unchanged. Because the 2008 Farm Bill amended the Federal Crop Insurance Act (FCIA) to require that EU subsidies deliver the same per-acre dollar amount of subsidy as a BU or OU would, the published schedule raises the EU rates in step at the 75, 80, and 85 percent coverage levels, where they had been below the 80 percent statutory maximum; the lower EU levels were already at that maximum and do not change.

The program's own experience after 2008 is the clearest guide to what may follow. When the 2008 Farm Bill first raised EU subsidies, the producer-paid premium on the more aggregated unit fell sharply relative to OU and BU, and over the following decade acreage migrated decisively from BU and OU toward EU, the shift documented in Section 4 (Figure 7), while academic work found that the change attenuated a

pre-existing asymmetric-information margin between unit structures (Tsiboe et al., 2025b).

Figure 18: ***Premium Subsidy Schedule under Current Rules and under the One Big Beautiful Bill Act, by Coverage Level and Unit Structure.***



Note: Premium subsidy rates by coverage level and unit structure under the published Risk Management Agency premium subsidy schedules for the 2025 program year, in effect before the change, and the 2026 program year, which carries the premium subsidy increases enacted in the One Big Beautiful Bill Act (OBBB), signed on July 4, 2025. The Enterprise Unit (EU) rates for 2026 reflect the adjustment required by the 2008 Farm Bill amendment to the Federal Crop Insurance Act, which requires that EU subsidies provide the same dollar amount of premium subsidy per acre as a Basic or Optional Unit, to the maximum extent practicable. Rates are the published schedule values used for the report's subsidy-schedule table and are not author calculations. Basic and Optional Units share a common schedule and are shown together.

Source: NDSU Agricultural Risk Policy Center (ARPC) using USDA Risk Management Agency published premium subsidy schedules for the 2025 and 2026 program years, as of October 15, 2026.

The OBBB acts on the same margin from the opposite direction: by raising BU and OU subsidies and aligning the EU schedule with them, it narrows the producer-paid premium gap that drew acreage into the EU in the first place. If producers respond to that narrower gap as the 2008 episode suggests they respond to subsidy-driven cost changes, with lower-risk, more cost-responsive producers the most likely to move, some acreage could migrate back toward more disaggregated BU and OU, slowing or partially reversing the post-2008 trend (Yu and Perry, 2024). The same logic has an adverse-selection counterpart: as BU and OU subsidies approach per-acre parity with EU, producers gain a stronger incentive to isolate localized risk in smaller units while retaining subsidy support close to the EU level, which could re-open part of the selection margin the 2008 expansion had compressed. How much of this materializes remains uncertain; it depends on farm-level economics this report does not estimate. This report establishes the unit-structure baseline against which any such reversal would be measured.

OBBB and the Supplemental Layer

The OBBB acts on a second margin above the basic policy. It raises the premium subsidy on the supplemental endorsements to 80 percent, and RMA has implemented that increase through a targeted rollout under Manager's Bulletin MGR-25-006 rather than a new rule: the 80 percent rate applies to the Supplemental Coverage Option (SCO) and Enhanced Coverage Option (ECO) for policies with sales closing dates on or after July 1, 2025 (Risk Management Agency [RMA], 2025b; Tsiboe and Zhao, 2026). A later bulletin, PM-26-036, then raises the SCO coverage cap from 86 to 90 percent and makes corresponding coverage-level changes to the ECO and Margin Coverage Option, effective with the 2027 crop year for crops with a June 30, 2026 contract change date and the 2028 crop year for crops with earlier dates (Risk Management Agency [RMA], 2026). Together these changes sharply lower the producer-paid premium per dollar of supplemental coverage.

Early 2026 evidence is consistent with a substantial response. ECO policy sales rose from approximately 231 thousand in 2025 to 531 thousand in 2026, and SCO policy sales rose from 63 thousand to 313 thousand over the same period. Projecting forward using historical acres-per-policy ratios, ECO adoption could reach 51.6 percent of eligible acres in 2026 (up from 19.3 percent in 2025), and SCO adoption could reach 23.3 percent (up from 3 percent) (Tsiboe and Zhao, 2026). These figures should be read as preliminary policy-count projections rather than realized acreage; their interpretation depends on the stability of historical acres-per-policy ratios and on the completion of 2026 acreage reporting. Even with that caveat, the observed change in policy sales is directionally consistent with the OBBB subsidy mechanics, and the supplemental layer appears positioned to grow substantially under the new subsidy structure.

That cap increase is a second-stage change that is structural rather than a further subsidy-rate increase. Raising the SCO cap to 90 percent extends the first-tier band from the producer's underlying coverage level up to 90 percent, absorbing the 86 to 90 percent band that in 2026 could be reached only through the ECO. That absorption forces the rest of the reconfiguration. SCO is a public FCIC product and the ECO is privately developed, and because a private multi-peril product may not operate in the same coverage band as a public multi-peril product, once the expanded public SCO occupies the ground up to 90 percent the ECO 90 percent option, which covered exactly that 86 to 90 percent band, is removed, and the ECO 95 percent option must attach at 90 rather than 86 percent, leaving it to cover only the 90 to 95 percent band. A producer who wanted area coverage up to 90 percent, and who in 2026 had to pair SCO with ECO to get there, can in 2027 obtain it through SCO alone.

Because the 80 percent subsidy was already in force in 2026, the 2027 reconfiguration acts on producer cost through the repricing of the two endorsements rather than through the subsidy rate. The expanded SCO covers a wider and higher band, so its total premium, and the roughly one-fifth of it the producer pays after subsidy, rise in absolute terms even though the subsidy rate is unchanged; in exchange the producer obtains four more points of area coverage from a single first-tier endorsement. ECO 95 moves the other way: shorn of the 86 to 90 percent band, its total premium falls, but because it now retains only the 90 to 95 percent slice, the portion of the deductible nearest the expected outcome and therefore the most frequently triggered, its cost per point of coverage rises. For a producer targeting 95 percent coverage the total premium is largely conserved, because the 86 to 90 percent band is relabeled from ECO to SCO rather than newly subsidized; the net effect on out-of-pocket cost turns on how SCO's premium rate for that band compares with the ECO rate it replaces.

The subsidy gain relative to 2026 is therefore smaller than the headline cap increase suggests. The large reduction in producer-paid supplemental cost had already occurred in 2026, when the subsidy rate rose from 65 to 80 percent across SCO and ECO (Risk Management Agency [RMA], 2025b); the 2027 change mainly rearranges which endorsement carries the 86 to 90 percent band and reprices the two products around the same 80 percent rate. How much producers ultimately save, and whether consolidating the 86 to 90 percent band into the more heavily used SCO draws additional acreage into that range, will depend on RMA's 2027 premium rates for the reconfigured SCO and ECO, which were not yet in the published subsidy schedule when this report was prepared. This report establishes the supplemental-layer baseline against which that response would be measured.

EARP and Coverage Substitution

The EARP final rule removes a separate adjustment margin from producer policy design. Until EARP takes effect for a crop, in the 2026 or 2027 crop year depending on its contract change date, producers could purchase prevented-planting buy-up coverage to raise the share of pre-planting costs reimbursed when weather or another insured cause prevents timely planting; thereafter, prevented-planting protection will depend entirely on the elected basic policy coverage level (Chakravorty et al., 2025; Tsiboe et al., 2026a). A producer who wanted to preserve the lost protection would have to carry a higher basic coverage level. Still, that route is only partly available: it narrows as producers approach the 85 percent statutory coverage ceiling, and producers already at 85 percent, much of the row-crop core, cannot substitute at all (Tsiboe et al., 2025a; Tsiboe, 2026). This substitution question is itself now unsettled: on July 21, 2026,

USDA committed to restoring the buy-up option, which would, if finalized by RMA, remove the need to substitute for the crops and years the restoration reaches, though its effective timing and scope await formal guidance and the 2026 coverage gap would remain (Chakravorty et al., 2026).

The last comparable change again offers the closest historical guide. When the prior 10 percentage-point prevented-planting buy-up was eliminated beginning with the 2018 crop year, producer responses were slow and incomplete, and indemnified prevented-planting acreage rose through the 2020 to 2022 period in a pattern more consistent with an unfilled protection gap than with a clean substitution into higher coverage (Tsiboe et al., 2026a). That episode did not follow the removal of an underperforming product: the aggregate actuarial evidence indicates the buy-up's premiums tracked the additional risk it covered rather than subsidizing it (Turner and Tsiboe, 2025). By analogy, removing the 5 percentage-point buy-up may likewise leave a residual gap rather than prompt full substitution, concentrated among the high-coverage producers who have the least room to move up. The OBBB subsidy increases lower the cost of substituting into higher coverage for some producers. Still, the relief is uneven across states and unit structures, and ad-hoc disaster assistance has historically filled only part of such gaps (Tsiboe et al., 2025c; Tsiboe et al., 2026a). How producers actually respond, and how much prevented-planting exposure they retain, will depend on farm-level economics beyond this report's scope; this report establishes the coverage-level baseline against which that response would be measured.

The two confirmed actions act across three layers of the producer election sequence: OBBB on the unit-structure margin and on the supplemental layer above the basic policy, and EARP on the coverage-level and prevented-planting margin. The forward-looking implications discussed here are those for which existing ARPC research and the academic literature already provide an empirical or institutional basis. Observed shifts in 2026 and later years will reflect the joint effect of the new menu, the new subsidy schedule, the prior distribution of producer elections, and weather and price conditions; this report does not estimate the marginal causal effect of any single change. Subsequent ARPC reports will revisit the descriptive distributions documented here as post-implementation participation data become available, allowing observed producer responses to be compared against the prospective patterns sketched here.

Conclusion

This report documents how U.S. producers configure an FCIP policy across the staged sequence of producer elections that defines an insured contract: unit structure, basic insurance plan, coverage level, basic policy options and endorsements, and supplemental coverage. Using 2006–2025 FCIP data, it characterizes the distribution of insured acres and liabilities across each layer and reports the commodity- and region-specific patterns that the national aggregates conceal. The five body sections, together with the policy-structure framing, establish a consistent descriptive baseline against which post-2025 program changes can be measured. As context for interpreting these liability comparisons, the report also notes that insured liability tracks the producer's share of interest, which is near 95 percent program-wide and lowest in the row-crop core. The same framing applies upstream of every election: the breadth of the published offer, widest in field crops and the crop-diverse states, sets the outer bound on what any producer can elect, while the small and steadily shrinking written-agreement channel shows bespoke coverage being progressively absorbed into that standard offer.

Three structural shifts stand out in the descriptive evidence. First, the plan-group mix has moved decisively to individual revenue coverage: RP alone carries the largest single share of program liability in the row-crop core; area- and index-based plans, led by PRF, account for most of the program's recent acreage growth despite their small liability share. Second, coverage intensity has climbed, with acres accumulating in the 80–85 and 90–95 percent bands at the expense of the 50–55 and Catastrophic bands. Third, the EU has overtaken the OU as the modal acreage-pooling structure in the row-crop core, a shift that dates from the 2008 Farm Bill's higher EU subsidies; under enterprise pooling, the producer-paid premium per acre remains markedly lower than under OU or BU. Each national pattern conceals pronounced commodity-by-region heterogeneity in the underlying state and commodity-group distributions.

The basic policy options layer and the supplemental coverage layer round out the producer-choice picture. Among the options elected on top of a basic policy, yield-history modifiers carry the largest share of insured option-acres in 2025, with Yield Adjustment the most-elected single option and Yield Cup, Trend Adjustment, and Yield Exclusion also widely used. Quality, prevented-planting buy-up, acreage-treatment, and unit sub-elections each carry smaller but policy-relevant shares, with concentrations tied to commodity-specific contract design and exposure; the prevented-planting buy-up stands out among these, because the acres electing it are precisely those affected as EARP winds that coverage down, a removal USDA committed in July 2026 to reverse, pending formal RMA guidance

(Chakravorty et al., 2026). Supplemental products have layered selectively onto the basic policy, with SCO and ECO accelerating in field crops following the 2021 introduction of ECO and the OBBB subsidy increases that took effect with the July 2025 sales closings. HIP-WI and STAX continue to carry their characteristic geographic and commodity footprints.

The report's scope remains as stated at the outset: descriptive and institutional, documenting what producers chose without estimating causal effects, evaluating welfare outcomes, or advancing policy recommendations. The two confirmed policy actions discussed act across three layers of the producer election sequence and are positioned to reshape several of the distributions documented here: the OBBB raises premium subsidies on both the unit-structure margin and the supplemental layer above the basic policy (the latter implemented through Manager's Bulletin MGR-25-006), and the EARP final rule eliminates the 5 percentage-point prevented-planting buy-up. Section 9 frames the prospective producer responses and the conditions under which they would be observed. The baselines this report establishes are the benchmark for measuring those responses as post-implementation data become available. As this report went to press, USDA committed on July 21, 2026, to restoring the prevented-planting buy-up eliminated under EARP; the reversal awaits formal RMA guidance and does not undo the 2026 coverage gap (Chakravorty et al., 2026).

Appendix A: Data and Methodology

This appendix provides the full methodological detail summarized in the Data and Methods section.

Data Sources and Vintage

The primary source is the USDA Risk Management Agency (RMA) Summary of Business (SOB), used here as a transaction-level (type-practice-unit) extract. It is supplemented by the RMA Insurance Choice Election (ICE) catalog, which supplies the basic policy option names and functional categories used in Section 7, and by producer-level administrative records from the Federal Crop Insurance Program (FCIP) Policy Acceptance and Storage System (PASS) where finer detail is required. The scope-of-offer exhibits (Section 3), the premium subsidy schedule table (Table 1), and the Outlook subsidy schedule figure (Figure 18) draw on the RMA Actuarial Data Master (ADM), which publishes the insurable offer and the statutory premium subsidy schedule by program year. Commodity groupings, insurance-plan recodes, and unit-structure recodes are applied from the project's recode tables. All SOB exhibits are built from the same data release, with a data vintage of October 15, 2026; the producer-level share-of-interest and price-percent extracts carry their own vintage, noted in the corresponding figure source lines. National time-series exhibits cover crop years 2006 through 2025.

Unit of Analysis

The unit of analysis varies by exhibit and is stated in each section:

- Unit structure (Section 4): commodity-year-by-unit-type for the national time series; state-by-commodity-group for the current-year spatial grid.
- Basic insurance plan (Section 5): plan-group-by-commodity-year.
- Coverage level (Section 6): commodity-year-by-coverage-level band for the national time series; state-by-commodity-group-by-period for the spatial grid.
- Basic policy options (Section 7): option-by-commodity-year, with current-year cross-sections for the

reference panel.

- Supplemental coverage (Section 8): commodity-group-by-product-by-year for the acreage series; county-by-product-by-year for the adoption maps.
- Share of interest (Section 3) and elected price percent (Section 5): acre- weighted commodity- and state-level means by year.
- Scope of offer and written agreements (Section 3): crop-county-type-practice offer records for the offer-count figures; acre-weighted commodity- and state-level written-agreement shares.
- Outlook (Section 9): coverage-level-by-unit-structure-by-program-year for the subsidy schedule figure; the prevented-planting substitution figure and the early supplemental-adoption figures are described in the Outlook exhibits subsection below.

Key Variable Definitions

Net reported acres. Acres are taken from the SOB net reporting-level amount for rows whose reporting level is denominated in acres; quantities reported on a tree, plant, or dollar basis are set to zero so that tree-equivalent and dollar-denominated units do not enter acreage totals. Prevented-planting acreage is included within net reported acres rather than treated as a separate category. Acres are reported in millions.

Insured liability. The SOB liability amount is reported in billions of nominal U.S. dollars. Liability is not deflated to a base-year price level because the focus is the within-year distribution of liability across policy-design features, not real dollar growth over time.

Premium subsidy rate and producer-paid premium per acre (Section 4). The subsidy rate is the share of total premium covered by the federal subsidy (subsidy amount divided by total premium). The producer-paid premium per insured acre is total premium net of subsidy, divided by insured acres. Both are computed after aggregation so that the reported averages are acre- and dollar-weighted across the underlying policies.

Unit-structure groups. The SOB unit-structure code is consolidated into three buckets: Optional Units (OU, comprising standard Optional and Undivided units), Basic Units (BU), and Enterprise Units (EU, comprising standard Enterprise Units, Enterprise Units by Practice, Multi-County Enterprise Units, and

Whole-Farm Units, which are folded into EU because their acreage shares are too small to read at the chart scale but remain separately identified in the underlying data).

Plan groups (Section 5). The RMA basic plan codes are consolidated into the seven groups defined in Section 5 by trigger level and protected outcome. The exhibit builds the default bucket as Other Index and then explicitly peels off the individual, area (group yield or revenue), whole-farm, dollar, and rainfall-index groups; the full membership of each of the seven groups is reproduced in the note to the plan figure (Figure 10).

Coverage-level bands (Section 6). Elected coverage levels are collapsed into six bands: Catastrophic (CAT), 50-55, 60-65, 70-75, 80-85, and 90-95 percent. The CAT band is identified using the RMA catastrophic-delivery flag; all other bands are formed from the elected coverage-level percentage. For the spatial figure, the reported value is the binned aggregate coverage level within each state-commodity-group-period cell, for comparability reasons explained in Figure 14 in Section 6.

Share of interest and elected price percent (Sections 3 and 5). Both are reported as acre-weighted means, computed in the producer-level extract; the state maps then average those cell means over the years shown. The elected price-percent figure is restricted to Individual Yield plans, for the contract-design reason explained in Section 5.

Scope of offer (Section 3). The offer count is the number of insurable unit-structure options (optional, basic, enterprise, and whole-farm) published in the RMA Actuarial Data Master for each crop-county-type-practice offer, summed to the reporting unit; it measures the breadth of the published menu rather than what producers elected.

Written-agreement share (Section 3). The acre-weighted share of insured acres covered under a written agreement rather than the standard published offer, drawn from the producer-level records.

Basic policy options (Section 7). Option names and the eight functional categories are drawn from the ICE catalog. Because options are not mutually exclusive at the policy level, option-acre shares are computed as composition within elected options rather than as participation rates.

Supplemental adoption (Section 8). Adoption is the share of eligible insured acreage enrolled in a supplemental plan; the eligibility conditions (a qualifying basic policy and the product actually being offered in the county) are stated with Figure 17 in Section 8.

Filtering and Transformation Steps

The exhibit builders apply a consistent sequence. Livestock and animal-products policies are dropped (commodity-group flag), and rows with missing liability are removed. The plan set retained then depends on the exhibit. The unit-structure exhibits (Section 4) are restricted to the individual-based plans, Actual Production History (APH), Yield Protection (YP), Revenue Protection (RP), and Revenue Protection with Harvest Price Exclusion (RP-HPE). These plans allow a unit-structure election. The national coverage-level band series (Section 6) instead pools all plan families, retaining area- and index-based plans as well; this pooling is the subject of the third limitation below. The coverage-level spatial grid restricts to individual-trigger plans, and the elected price-percent exhibit (Section 5) is restricted more narrowly to Individual Yield plans (APH and YP), for the contract-design reason noted above. Acres and liability are converted to millions and billions, respectively. Records are aggregated to the exhibit's unit of analysis; an "All Crops" rollup is formed by summing across the five commodity groups, and within-cell shares are computed so that each figure displays composition. At the same time, absolute values are retained in the saved data files that the narrative reads. States are assigned to the four U.S. Census regions (Northeast, Midwest, South, West) for the regional summaries, and fixed factor orderings are applied so legend and panel ordering are stable across rebuilds.

Period Windows by Exhibit

The national plan, coverage-level, and unit-structure time series cover 2006 through 2025. The share-of-interest and elected price-percent series (Sections 3 and 5) both begin in 2011, the earliest year available in the underlying producer-level extract, and run through 2025. The unit-structure spatial grid summarizes the current year (2025) so the regional snapshot reflects current program conditions. The coverage-level spatial grid uses four trailing windows (2008–2013, 2014–2017, 2018–2023, and 2024–2025) so that compositional change can be read across broader periods. The Section 7 basic policy options reference panel is restricted to the 2025 crop year, documenting the menu actually offered in the current year rather than the historical universe. The supplemental exhibits in Section 8 begin in 2015, when the supplemental layer (starting with the Supplemental Coverage Option, SCO) entered the program.

Outlook Exhibits (Section 9)

The Outlook exhibits are prospective and rest on published rules and prior research rather than the Summary of Business participation data used elsewhere. The premium subsidy schedule figure (Figure 18) compares the RMA-published premium subsidy rates by coverage level and unit structure for the 2025 and 2026 program years, drawn from the same Actuarial Data Master subsidy schedule release used for Table 1; the rates are published values, not author calculations. The prevented-planting substitution figure is a mechanical illustration of the coverage-level increase needed to replace the eliminated buy-up, computed as the buy-up percentage divided by a crop's prevented-planting coverage factor (illustrated for corn at a 60 percent factor) and plotted only where the implied coverage stays within the 85 percent statutory ceiling. The early supplemental-adoption figures are preliminary policy-count comparisons and acres-per-policy projections carried over from the companion ARPC brief; they are policy counts rather than settled acreage totals and are labeled as preliminary in the text. The confirmed 2025–2027 policy changes referenced in the Outlook and cataloged in Appendix B are drawn from individually cited RMA bulletins and final rules.

Limitations

The analysis is descriptive and institutional; it does not estimate causal effects, evaluate welfare outcomes, or make policy recommendations. Six limitations should be kept in mind.

First, the SOB records what producers purchased, not the full set of plans, coverage levels, and unit structures available to them. Observed shares therefore reflect both producer preferences and the availability of each policy feature in each crop-county combination.

Second, coverage levels are not directly comparable across plans; a 75 percent yield policy and a 75 percent revenue policy provide different guarantees. The coverage-level distribution should be read mainly as a within-plan-family summary rather than a single program-wide intensity measure.

Third, the coverage-level band time series pools plan families. Area- and index-based plans, chiefly the Pasture, Rangeland, and Forage Rainfall Index (PRF), combine high nominal coverage with low per-acre liability, so they inflate the acreage at the upper bands relative to the liability there. The band acreage shares are therefore not a clean measure of buy-up intensity and are best interpreted alongside the per-acre liability contrasts reported in Section 5.

Fourth, supplemental products are reported only as shares of liability and acreage. Producers' joint elections of base policies and supplemental endorsements are not decomposed in this issue; that joint analysis is provided in the companion ARPC backgrounder on supplemental insurance.

Fifth, because a single insured policy can carry multiple options simultaneously, summed option-acres double-count policies that elect more than one option; the Section 7 shares are correspondingly composition shares, as defined above.

Sixth, administrative records for the most recent crop year (2025) continue to accumulate after the data vintage used here, so final-year values, particularly acre-weighted means such as the elected price percent, are preliminary and may partly reflect the changing composition of reported policies rather than settled program totals.

Appendix B: Confirmed Policy Changes

Beyond the OBBB and EARP changes examined in the Outlook section, additional confirmed Risk Management Agency (RMA) actions widen or modify the 2027 election menu in narrower ways. Bulletin identifiers are shown for reference.

- **Other Expanding Access to Risk Protection (EARP) final rule provisions (PM-25-072).** Apart from the prevented-planting buy-up removal discussed in the Outlook section, the rule expands the Dollar Plan to direct-marketed fresh market tomatoes and peppers, extends beginning and veteran farmer benefits from 5 to 10 crop years, and clarifies revenue-protection harvest-price handling. Effective the 2026 crop year for crops with a November 30, 2025 contract change date and the 2027 crop year for crops with an earlier contract change date.
- **Common Crop Insurance Policy, Catastrophic Risk Protection Endorsement, and Peak Endorsement Pilot (PM-26-022).** Alongside conforming updates to the Basic Provisions and the catastrophic (CAT) endorsement, this introduces the Peak Endorsement Pilot. This new optional add-on lets a producer temporarily raise the amount of insurance during a declared high-value window within the crop year. The producer files a peak selected value report giving the higher value and its start and end dates and pays a duration-adjusted premium on the added amount, which cannot exceed twice the underlying amount of insurance; it is available for any crop whose actuarial documents publish a rate. Effective the 2027 crop year.
- **Crop insurance policy changes (PM-26-040).** A cross-cutting update to the Basic Provisions and several crop provisions that reinstates the "1 in 4" prevented-planting rule nationwide and clarifies that it can be satisfied only with insurable crops, adds automatic authority for a spouse to sign, and relocates optional-unit language into the Crop Provisions. Effective the 2027 crop year for crops with a June 30, 2026 contract change date and the 2028 crop year for crops with earlier dates.
- **Hurricane Insurance Protection-Wind Index (HIP-WI) (PM-26-023).** Allows HIP-WI to be combined with any FCIC-reinsured endorsement, policy, or option that covers part of the underlying deductible without duplicating HIP-WI coverage, where it had previously been limited to a named set; permits written agreements in any county where HIP-WI is offered; and updates the rainfall data source to NOAA's National Centers for Environmental Information. Effective the 2027 crop year, with an April 30, 2026 contract change date.

- **Florida citrus (PM-25-052).** Adds two insurable tangerine varieties, UF 950 and Gold Nugget, and relaxes the production-history requirements older trees must meet to qualify, widening the coverage available to Florida citrus growers. Effective 2027.
- **Canola and rapeseed (PM-26-035).** Revises the crop provisions to allow enterprise units by type, letting producers pool canola and rapeseed acreage into enterprise units differentiated by type rather than a single combined unit, a unit-structure option not previously available for these crops. Effective the 2027 crop year for counties with a June 30, 2026 contract change date and 2028 for others.
- **Forage Production (PM-26-033).** Converts the Forage Production Actual Production History plan to Yield Protection, Revenue Protection, and Revenue Protection with Harvest Price Exclusion in select counties across twelve states, bringing revenue coverage to forage for the first time; existing policies convert automatically to YP unless the producer elects RP or RP-HPE by the sales closing date. Effective the 2027 crop year.
- **Production and Revenue History (PM-26-020).** Adds optional units by non-contiguous land, permits coverage by written agreement, standardizes the frequency of harvest-price computation, and clarifies cost-tolerance handling, for the PRH plan and its strawberry pilot provisions. Effective the 2027 crop year.
- **Turfgrass Value Select (PM-26-038).** Introduces the program's first-ever insurance for turfgrass growers, a Value Select pilot offering 50 to 85 percent coverage in select counties across ten states (Alabama, Florida, Georgia, Illinois, Minnesota, Missouri, North Carolina, Oklahoma, South Carolina, and Texas). Effective the 2027 crop year, with a September 1, 2026 initial sales closing date.
- **Dry Pea Revenue Endorsement (PM-26-034).** Adds premium reimbursement when a harvest price cannot be determined, aligning the endorsement with the Common Crop Insurance Policy so a producer is not left having paid for revenue protection that cannot be priced. Effective the 2027 crop year.
- **Controlled Environment and Nursery Value Select pilots (PM-26-006).** For the Controlled Environment pilot, extends insurable plant-disease losses beyond formally regulated diseases to those monitored by APHIS or state governments, makes buffer-zone plants indemnifiable when destroyed under an official quarantine or destruction order, and broadens the definition of contamination. For both pilots, lets a transfer of coverage attach to the transferee at the start of the crop year when it is filed during the prior year's waiting period. Effective 2027.
- **Rainfall Index: Pasture, Rangeland, and Forage (PM-25-054).** Tightens the documentation behind an

insurable interest, requiring proof of ownership, a signed lease, or a share arrangement filed by the acreage reporting date, and specifies that contiguous acreage crossing a state line is insured in the state holding most of it. Also aligns beginning and veteran farmer subsidy definitions with the OBBB and clarifies the consequences of unverifiable or inaccurate information. Provision updates effective 2026, and 2027 for plans with a contract change date before August 31, 2025.

- **Livestock plans: LRP, LGM, and DRP (PM-26-024).** Permits concurrent coverage across similar livestock programs, requires cancellation of policies that earn no premium for three consecutive years, and refreshes beginning-farmer and subsidy provisions; program-specific changes include extending LRP Cull Cow coverage to 52 weeks and adding feeder-cattle weight categories, raising the LGM maximum cattle weight, and aligning DRP sales-period dates with the other livestock plans. Modifications effective 2027; livestock lies outside this report's crop-insurance scope but is listed here for completeness.

- **County crop program expansions and deletions (MGR-26-007, MGR-26-008).** Illustrate the annual movement in the published offer. For the April 30 contract change date, Forage Seeding is added in 26 counties across Arizona, California, Illinois, Indiana, and Nevada, and Sugar Beets is removed in Imperial County, California; for the June 30 date, Canola is added in two Missouri counties and Wheat in one Iowa and one Wisconsin county, while Barley is removed in three Georgia and two South Carolina counties. Effective the 2027 crop year.

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The Agricultural Risk Policy Center at North Dakota State University conducts independent, evidence-based economic research to inform agricultural policy and strengthen the farm safety net. Our work focuses on evaluating risk management tools such as crop insurance and disaster assistance, analyzing market disruptions, and providing timely insights that support agricultural producers, policymakers, and industry leaders.

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